肖邦钢琴全集

叙事曲

作品 23、38、47、52

波兰国家版

URTEXT

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原版引进
ORIGINAL EDITION LICENSING

BALLADES

Opp.23,38,47,52

CHOPIN

扬·艾凯尔 编订

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URTEXT

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CHOPIN

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Opp. 23, 38, 47, 52

波兰国家版

NATIONAL EDITION

弗雷德里克·肖邦作品集

WORKS OF FRYDERYK CHOPIN

扬·艾凯尔编订

Edited by JAN EKIER

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本集编者：扬・艾凯尔

《演奏注释》和《版本注释》(精简本)附在本书最后。
完整的《版本注释》将独立成册出版。

国家版弗雷德里克・肖邦作品集"引言"介绍：

1. 编辑事宜：所有涉及出版的问题都包括在引言中。
2. 演奏事宜：所有涉及音乐诠释的问题也被包括在引言中。

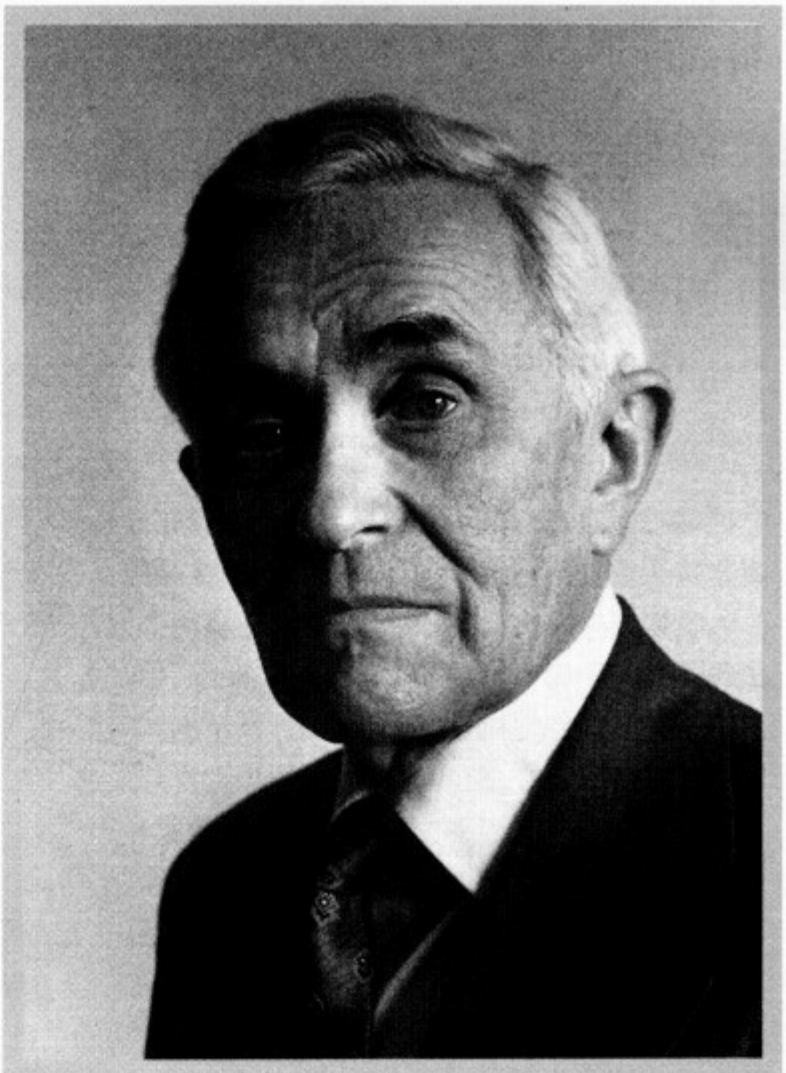
Editors of this Volume: Jan Ekier, Paweł Kamiński

A *Performance Commentary* and a *Source Commentary (abridged)* are included in each volume in the form of a loose insert.

Full *Source Commentaries* on each volume are published separately.

The *Introduction to the National Edition of the Works of Fryderyk Chopin*
1. *Editorial Problems*, published as a separate volume, covers general matters concerning the publication.
The *Introduction...* 2. *Problems of Performance* covers all general questions of interpretation.

A 系列是肖邦生前出版的作品。本书为 A 系列之一。
SERIES A. WORKS PUBLISHED DURING CHOPIN'S LIFETIME. VOLUME I



中文版序
Slowo do wydania chińskiego Wydania narodowego Dzieł F.Chopina

Ogromną radość sprawia mi fakt, że redagowane przeze mnie wydanie źródłowe Dzieł Chopina będzie dostępne na rynku księgarskimw Waszym kraju. Kiedy przed ćwierć wiekiem miałem okazję go odwiedzić, zauważyłem u pianistycznej młodzieży chińskiej znakomite dyspozycje do wykonywania muzyki Chopina. Nastąpne lata potwierdziły tę moją opinię sukcesami chińskich pianistów na estradach świata i Polski, też na Konkursach Chopinowskich. Życzę chińskiej młodzieży pianistycznej, jak również pedagogom, muzykologom i melomanom jak najlepszego poznania muzyki największego polskiego twórcy muzycznego, którego pełnemu zrozumieniu ma służyć nasze wydanie.

波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》

在中国图书市场上将出现由我本人编订的原始版肖邦作品集，我十分欣慰。上世纪 80 年代初，我曾有机会访问中国。当时我就在中国钢琴学子身上发现，他们具有演奏肖邦音乐的良好素质。在之后的年代里，中国的钢琴家在波兰和世界的舞台上，以及在肖邦钢琴比赛上所取得的成就，都证实了我的看法。我要对中国钢琴青年以及教师、音乐学家和音乐爱好者致以真诚的祝愿，祝愿他们对波兰最伟大的作曲家的音乐能有更深透的认识，我们的这个版本正是为了充分理解肖邦而推出的。

扬·艾凯尔

2005 年 11 月 23 日

于华沙

翻译：梁全炳（原中国驻波兰大使馆文化参赞）

序 一

傅 聪

闻悉上海音乐出版社将出版由肖邦研究权威艾凯尔编订的波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》，甚感欣慰！从此，中国读者终于有幸拨开重重迷雾，正本清源，领略肖邦作品的真实面貌，并切实体会肖邦音乐的风格特色。

长期以来，对肖邦作品版本的考证是一个复杂的问题。其原因有二：一是肖邦的作品在世界各地拥有多个版本，即便是最值得信赖的手稿版，也同时拥有英国、法国、德国等多个版本，而各个版本又不尽相同，要确定哪个版本最为“准确”并非易事；二是肖邦本人经常对手稿进行修改，甚至上课时亦在其学生用谱上作大量改动。虽然这种带有“即兴”性质的创作符合他作为“钢琴诗人”的美誉，但却为后人试图接近肖邦的原来意图造成了困难。

肖邦作为一名近乎“家喻户晓”的作曲家和钢琴家，其作品被成千上万的演奏者广泛演奏和研究。这些演奏者和研究者对音乐的诠释亦千差万别，其中也不乏成功的诠释者，如科尔托，而更多的却是肆意的歪曲。19 世纪后期曾有一种风潮：演奏者假借“二度创作”之名，随意改动原作者的作品，甚至走向以演释者为中心的、更为“自我”的极端。肖邦的作品便是这种风潮的头号牺牲品。他的作品经常被一些不负责任的演奏家演释得虚弱哀婉、无病呻吟，甚至过于阴柔，阳刚不足。事实上，肖邦并非一般意义上肤浅的“沙龙明星”，他的作品具有相当的深度和力度，其内在张力和逻辑性非泛泛之辈可比。二次大战之后兴起的另一种学院派风格，用过度理性的学术思维判断其作品，并任意对和声、分句、踏板进行修改。例如在著名的前奏曲(op. 28)第 4 首中，有的“学院派”编订者把第 2—3 小节左手的降 E 改为升 D，以为只有这样才符合调性理论，即 E 和声小调的第七级音是升 D，但事实上这样就大错特错了，因为肖邦是把左手大拇指弹奏的这一连串音当作一个级进下行的声部，即 E—降 E—D。虽然降 E 与升 D 在钢琴上弹奏的是相同的音，但对于一个敏感的演奏者来说，这是完全不同的音响效果和情感表达。肖邦对踏板的处理也相当细腻，他并非只把踏板当作扩大音量的工具，而是能在画布上渲染出各种渐变色的奇妙画笔，因此往往需要经过反复揣摩。例如在前奏曲(op. 28)第 16 首中，一开始肖邦把这首作品的踏板处理成半小节一个踏板，后来可能认为不能完全表达本曲急风骤雨般的情绪，因此改为长踏板(在手稿影印件中可以清楚地看到这个删改过程)，虽然不及原来的踏板用法那样清晰，但这种稍嫌浑浊的音响更具有“风雨欲来”的震撼力。可惜直至如今，多数演奏家仍然使用着已被肖邦本人废弃的踏板用法。这样的例子不胜枚举，如若放任这种风潮肆意发展，我们最终将失去肖邦和他伟大的音乐！因此，去伪存真，还肖邦作品以原貌，已成为越来越多演奏者和研究者的共识和追求。

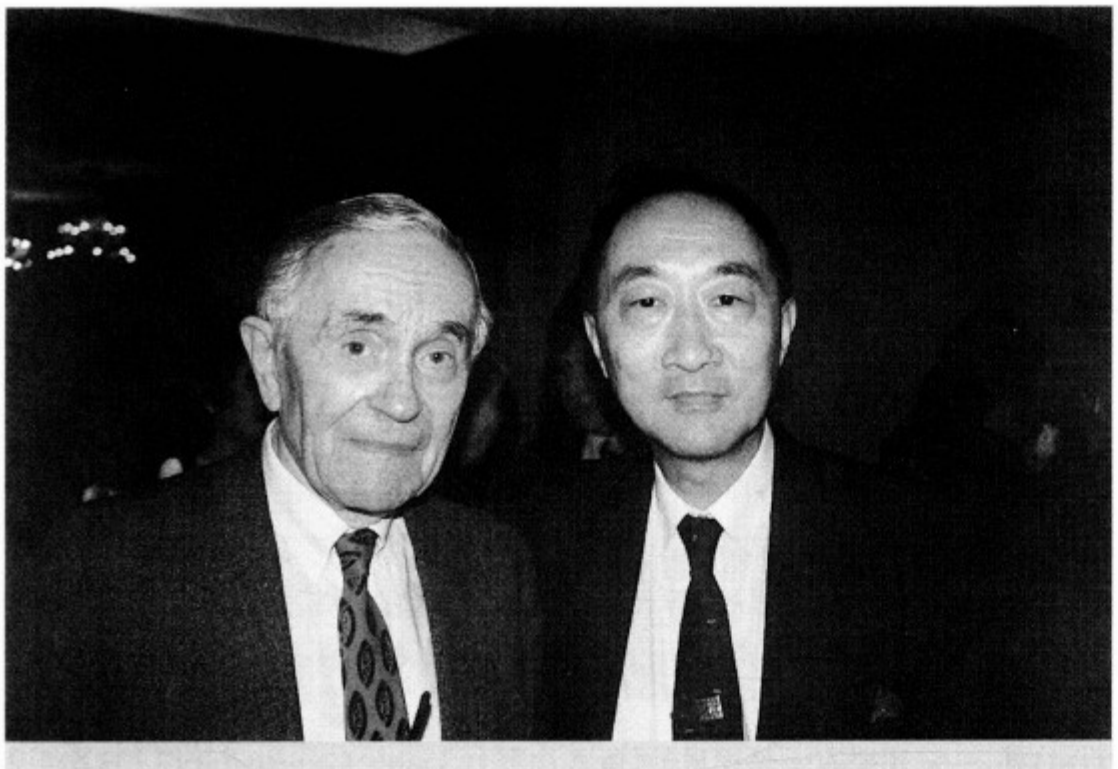
波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》的编订者艾凯尔是当今世界上最好的肖邦研究权威，这一点毫无疑问。我当年参加“肖邦国际钢琴比赛”时，他已经是非常知名的学者了。我们之间的交流和友情长达半世纪。我认为，艾凯尔是一位学识渊博、作风严谨、趣味独到的学者。他在肖邦研究领域的成就首先得益于他所拥有的一手资料。他掌握了几乎所有的版本，包括公开出版的作品集、手稿、学生用谱及一切有关于肖邦的文献。他用他那百科全书式的头脑，对各种线索进行推导和比较，加之他极富修养的个人趣味，才从中甄选出最符合肖邦原意的一种可能，并把其他的可能用文字和谱例加以注释，提供详尽的线索，使读者了解其来龙去脉，从不自作主张、强加于人。例如在前奏曲(op. 28)第 16 首中，第 20—21 小节的踏板记号为艾凯尔所加，并不代表肖邦的原意，因此艾凯尔用括号加以区别，其严谨的治学态度可见一斑。所以，我认为艾凯尔编订的版本是最接近于肖邦原作风貌的。

版本学的研究在世界艺术领域的地位越来越重要。作为一个富有修养的演奏者更应区分版本的好坏，因为这可能直接影响到对音乐的理解和诠释。但我们并不能否认“二度创作”的重要性，而是要在正确的基础上赋予“纸面上的”音乐以生命，使其更趋完美。这一点希望能与广大读者共勉。目前，多数世界性的国际钢琴比赛，包括声名远扬的“肖邦国际钢琴比赛”均推荐采用艾凯尔编订的版本，而新近成立的“波兰肖邦学会”也旨在大力推广它。此时，上海音乐出版社与波兰近乎同步出版这套新版本，无疑为中国读者做了件好事、大事。我热切盼望波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》尽快与广大读者见面，这必将是肖邦作品爱好者的饕餮盛宴！

2006 年 3 月 28 日于上海

序 二

李名强



1995 年李名强任第 13 届肖邦国际钢琴比赛评委时和艾凯尔教授合影

艾凯尔教授曾在 1983 年访问中国，并在北京中央音乐学院和上海音乐学院作有关肖邦的专题讲座。现在由他编订的波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》在中国出版，使他对肖邦的研究成果受到更广泛和全面的传播，相信必将又一次引起音乐界的重视，我谨在此向你们郑重推荐！

上海音乐出版社和波兰音乐出版有限公司（Polskie Wydawnictwo Muzyczne - PWM）协议特许在中国出版由扬·艾凯尔教授（Jan Ekier 1913 - ）编订的波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》。艾凯尔教授还专门为中文版写了序。这是中国出版界和音乐界的一件大事。

一、肖邦作品研究的最新成果

肖邦的作品是所有钢琴文献中被演奏得最多，但也是被篡改得最严重的。六十年前，我们不懂什么是“原始版”（Urtext），那时也没有“原始版”，以为只要是肖邦，什么版本都是一样的。后来才知道不是那么一回事，各种版本之间差异很大，有的是编订者有意修改，以为可以“改进”肖邦的原作（如 Karl Klindworth 版[1830 - 1916]），大多数是以讹传讹，以为本应如此。上世纪中，波兰出版了帕德雷夫斯基（Ignacy Jan Paderewski 1860 - 1941）版，在很大程度上澄清了以前的谬误，并开创了一个崭新的肖邦演奏风格。这个版本在国际上流行了整整半个世纪以上，但是它并不是一个严格意义上的“原始版”，它用所谓“标准化”的办法，把肖邦手稿中许多细微的变化“标准化”（简单化）了。

艾凯尔教授是当今最权威的肖邦专家，他本人是钢琴家、教授，有几十年的演奏和教学经验，又是一位学识渊博、治学严谨的学者，由他主持编订一部新的肖邦“原始版”当然是再合适不过的。这部新的“原始版”被波兰政府定为“国家版”，以示其重要性和权威性。艾凯尔教授不但根据肖邦的手稿、各种初版，而且掌握了肖邦教学时在学生用谱上作的许多修改和更正，因此他这个版本中有许多新的发现，和我们习惯听到的大异其趣。相信这将成为又一个新的里程碑。

二、历史

艾凯尔教授的版本在上世纪 60 年代就开始编订，由波兰音乐出版有限公司（PWM）和维也纳原始版公司（Wiener Urtext）联合出版，PWM 出版波兰文版，在波兰国内发行，维也纳原始版公司出版外文版，在全球发行。到上世纪 80 年代，维也纳已出版叙事曲、即兴曲、夜曲和诙谐曲共四种。后来波兰决定把艾凯尔版定为国家版（Wydanie Narodowe · National Edition）并由

PWM 独家出版，不再和维也纳原始版合作。已出的四种维也纳版是艾凯尔版的初稿，我们可以把它称为“旧版”，而现在 PWM 的是“新版”。旧版和新版的差别主要有：

1. 旧版按作品标题分类，如“夜曲”包括肖邦以夜曲命名的 21 首作品；“即兴曲”包括肖邦以即兴曲命名的所有 4 首作品。

新版分成 A 和 B 两个系列。A 系列为由肖邦生前自己编订作品号（到作品 65 为止）的作品。B 系列为肖邦身后由他的学生编订出版的作品。因此 A 系列的“夜曲”只包括肖邦生前出版的由作品 9 之 1 到作品 62 之 2 的 18 首。“即兴曲”也只包括作品 29，36 和 51 三首，而其他身后出版的（夜曲三首和幻想即兴曲作品 66）都放在 B 系列里面。

2. 新版是在旧版的基础上加上新发现的材料经过修订的最新成果。如最引起争议的第四首叙事曲第 124 小节右手第 9 和第 11 个十六分音符的高音由传统的 cb 和 fb 改成 CG 和 FG，旧版的《版本注释》只是指出音符的不同，没有说明理由，而新版有更详细具体的解说，由此你可以自己去思考和抉择艾凯尔的理由是否有道理。

3. 新版除了《版本注释》（Source Commentary），又增加了《演奏注释》（Performance Commentary），这是旧版所没有而对演奏非常有实用价值的。

PWM 的“新版”到现在为止只出版了 17 本，其余的据说将在两年内出齐。我们在此谨祝艾凯尔教授身体健康、工作顺利，其余的“新版”可以如期和读者见面。

三、善用“原始版”

有一种错误的观念认为“原始版”会束缚我们的手脚，使演奏千人一面缺乏个性。这是出于对“原始版”的误解和误用。事实正好相反：“原始版”为扩大我们的想象空间提供了一个最可靠的基础和出发点，让我们从一家之言走向百花齐放。当然，“原始版”本身也不是一成不变的。所有有生命力的东西都不可能是“绝对”的，而是进化的。把它绝对化，就是把它推上了死路。随着新资料的出现和科学研究的不断深入，“原始版”也会不断改进。不过这种改进不是随意的，而是有事实和科学根据的进步。

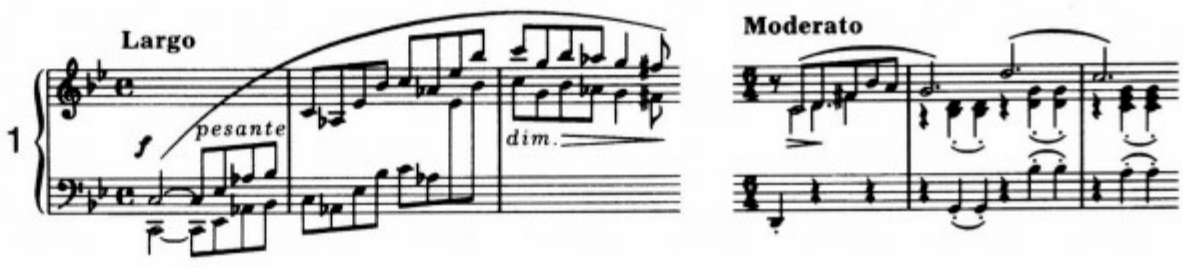
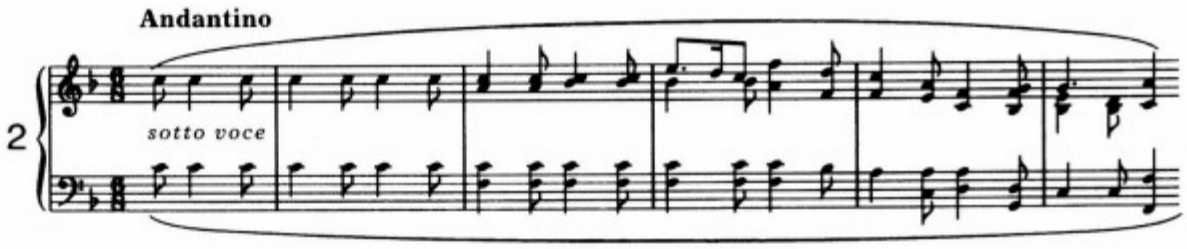
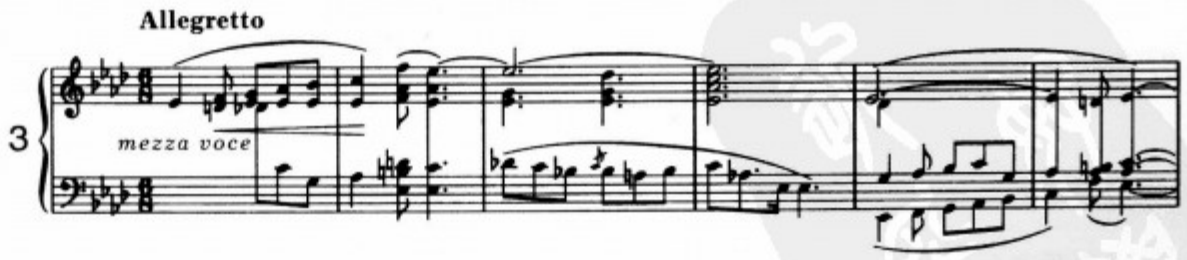
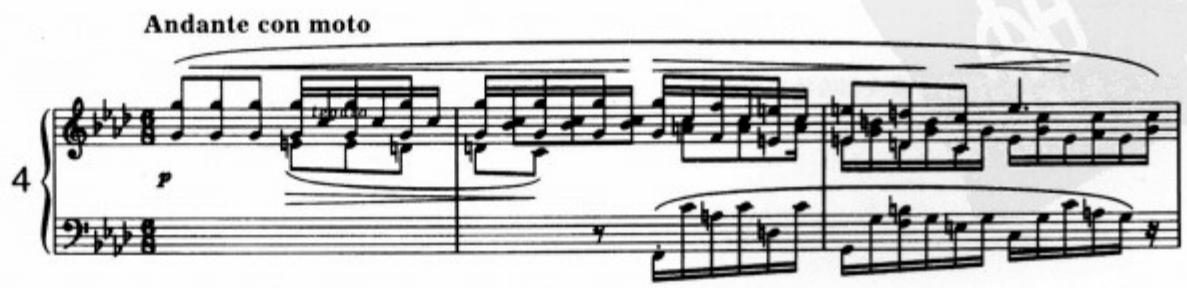
一个好的“原始版”除了可靠的乐谱文本（Text）外，一定还要有一份详尽的《版本注释》（Source Commentary）。这次上海音乐出版社决定除了组织一支以教授为首的强大专业力量把《版本注释》全文翻译成中文外，也把原来的英文本一起发表。这是一个十分重要的决定。我希望老师和同学们不仅要仔细研究乐谱文本，而且要认真阅读《版本注释》，学会全面地使用“原始版”。我也希望今后如果别的出版社申请用特许的办法在中国出版原始版，一定不要把《版本注释》删去。一个没有《版本注释》的所谓“原始版”只是一个不完整、“残障”的“原始版”。

四、一个榜样

最后，我要特别强调，这次上海音乐出版社和 PWM 协议，用特许（License）的办法引进波兰国家版《肖邦钢琴全集》是一个十分有远见、大胆而英明的决策，这个办法对双方都有好处。我们得到了最新、最好的版本，加快了我国钢琴演奏和教学与国际接轨的步伐，也为对方进入中国这个潜在的庞大市场铺了路，为在中国市场推广这个品牌创造了条件。我希望欧洲其他各大音乐出版社都能从中得到启发和教训，用这种合作的办法来推动一个持续双赢的局面。

2006 年 3 月

于香港知不足斋

G 小调叙事曲 op. 23 / Ballade in G minor Op. 23 page / s. 11

F 大调叙事曲 op. 38 / Ballade in F major Op. 38 page / s. 26

A♭ 大调叙事曲 op. 47 / Ballade in A♭ major Op. 47 page / s. 36

F 小调叙事曲 op. 52 / Ballade in F minor Op. 52 page / s. 48

引言·叙事曲

op. 23

"我收到肖邦新创作的一首《叙事曲》,这首曲子似乎与他的天赋最为接近(虽然算不上最精致)。我告诉他,在他所有的作品中我最喜欢这一首。经过很长一段时间沉默后他回信说:'我非常高兴你这么评价我这首曲子。我自己也同样最喜欢它,最珍视它。'"

舒曼给海因里希·德恩的信,1836 年 9 月 14 日,莱比锡。

op. 38

"……把我最后一首《叙事曲》的手稿寄给我,我想看一看。"

肖邦给巴黎的丰塔纳的信,1839 年 8 月 8 日。

"这段感情强烈的插段好像是后来加上去的。我记得非常清楚,1836 年 9 月肖邦弹这首《叙事曲》时以 F 大调结束,现在是结束在 A 小调上。"

舒曼,1888 年,莱比锡。

"比亚多特夫人告诉我,肖邦一再弹奏开始部分那段小行板,但从不弹后接的部分。"

圣-桑,1932 年,巴黎。

op. 47

"明天你就会收到那首《夜曲》,周末将收到《叙事曲》。……我没时间再给它做进一步润色了。"

肖邦给巴黎的丰塔纳的信,1841 年 10 月 18 日。

op. 52

"亲爱的先生:我谨向贵公司提供《谐谑曲》一首(开价 600 法郎),《叙事曲》一首(600 法郎),《波洛奈兹舞曲》一首(500 法郎)。如果贵公司觉得我的《谐谑曲》、《叙事曲》和《波洛奈兹舞曲》可以接受,请尽快给我回复,并指明我寄出这几首曲子的具体条件。

您诚挚的肖邦"

肖邦给莱比锡的布莱特考普夫和哈特尔公司的信,1842 年 12 月 15 日,巴黎。

about the Ballades ...

Op. 23

"I received a new Ballade from Chopin. It seems to be a work closest to his genius (although not the most ingenious) and I told him that I like it best of all his compositions. After quite a lengthy silence he replied with emphasis, 'I am happy to hear this since I too like it most and hold it dearest'."

From a letter by Robert Schumann to Heinrich Dorn, Leipzig 14 September 1836.

Op. 38

"[...] send me [...] the manuscript of my last Ballade because I want to see something."

From a letter by F. Chopin to Julian Fontana in Paris, Nohant 8 August 1839.

"The passionate episodes seem to have been added later; I recall precisely, that while playing the Ballade [September 1836], Chopin ended it in F major; now it ends in A minor."

Robert Schumann *Gesammelte Schriften über Musik und Musiker*, Leipzig 1888, vol. III.

"Madame Viardot told me that Chopin frequently played the opening Andantino but never that what follows."

Camille Saint-Saëns *Etude des Variantes* in "Trois manuscrits de Chopin", Paris 1932.

Op. 47

"Tomorrow you shall receive the Nocturne, and by the end of the week the Ballade [...] I am unable to polish it sufficiently."

From a letter by F. Chopin to Julian Fontana in Paris, Nohant 18 October 1841.

Op. 52

"Dear Sirs. I would like to offer you a Scherzo (for 600 fr.), a Ballade (for 600 fr.), and a Polonaise (for 500 fr.) [...]. If you find my Scherzo, Ballade and Polonaise acceptable, please write by the nearest post, indicating the term by which you would wish me to send these compositions. Sincerely devoted Fr. Chopin."

From a letter by F. Chopin to the Breitkopf & Härtel firm in Leipzig, Paris 15 December 1842.

叙事曲
Ballade

献给斯托克豪森男爵
A Monsieur le Baron de Stockhausen

op. 23

Largo*

1

f *pesante*

dim.

p

Moderato

5

Ped.

10

14

18

·参见《版本注释》。
Vide Source Commentary.

22

26

31

ritenuto

34

38

agitato

41

Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻

sempre più mosso

44

47

f

Ped ✻ Ped

50

Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻

53

Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻

56

59

calando - - - smorz.

62

meno mosso

sotto voce

ritenuto

65

pp

70

74

78

82

sempre *pp*

85

88

sempre

91

dim. - - - - - - - - - - - - - - - *rallentando* - - - - - - - - -

94

a tempo

pp

m.g. *m.g.*

98

m.g. *cresc.* *m.g.* ***fz*** ***pp*** *[m.g.* ***f***

102

m.g. *m.g.* *cresc.* *m.g.* *m.g.* *m.g.* *m.g.* *m.g.* *m.g.* *m.g.]*

106

ff

110

113

117

120

123

fff

dim.

più animato

126

cresc. - - -

129

Ped ✻

132

8

135

8

(*scherzando*)

138

Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻

141

144

147

150

cresc.

153

ff

156

leggieramente

fz p

159

8

ff

163

8

166

ff

fz

170

173

176

179

tr

con forza

ten.

182

ten.

sempre forte

185

188

191

ritenuto

dim.

rallent.

meno mosso

194

pp

sempre sotto voce

198

cresc.

f

p

f

202

cresc.

appassionato

poco ritenuto

206

il più forte possibile

Presto con fuoco

208

fz

212

fz

216

220

224

228

cresc.

232

8

236

ff

Ped

241

cresc.

8

245

Ped

248

Ped

251

ritenuto

accelerando

fz

p

f

Ped

255

ritenuto

accelerando

ff

p

Ped

258

fff poco ritenuto - - accele - - - ran - - - do

Ped

叙事曲
Ballade

献给罗伯特·舒曼先生
A Monsieur Robert Schumann

op. 38

Andantino

2

sotto voce

Ped

7

13

19

pp

25

31

37

42

smorzando

Presto con fuoco

47

ff

50

53

56

59

62

cresc.

65

8

68

ff

Ped

71

dim.

74

77

rallentando

80

tempo primo

83 **pp**

slentando

89

95

Ped ✻ Ped ✻ Ped ✻

101

Ped ✻

stretto, più mosso

107 *cresc.* *f* *cresc.* **ff**

• 八度上方的音也必须重复。
The upper notes of the octaves must also be repeated.

tempo primo

112

ritenuto

fz p

Ped

118

ritenuto

Ped Ped Ped

125

stretto, più mosso

131

cresc. f

cresc.

136

accel.

Presto con fuoco

141

1 3 1 2

Ped

144

8

1 2

Ped

147

150

Ped

Ped

8

153

cresc.

Ped

156

sempre forte

marcato

159

162

165

ff

agitato

169 *f*

172

175

178

181

184

cresc.

187

189 *ff*

192

195 *cresc.*

tempo primo

fz *pp*

199

叙事曲
Ballade

献给波琳·德·诺亚尤小姐
A Mademoiselle Pauline de Noailles

Allegretto

op. 47

3

mezza voce

6

f

11

p

f

15

19

ten.

Ped

36

* *a♭* 音要重复。
* The note *a♭* should be repeated.

ten.

cresc.

dim.

cresc.

legato

· tr = ~~

45

8

p

pp

50

mezza voce

56

61

cresc.

66

或：
* *ossia:*

71

ten.

76

cresc.

81

ff

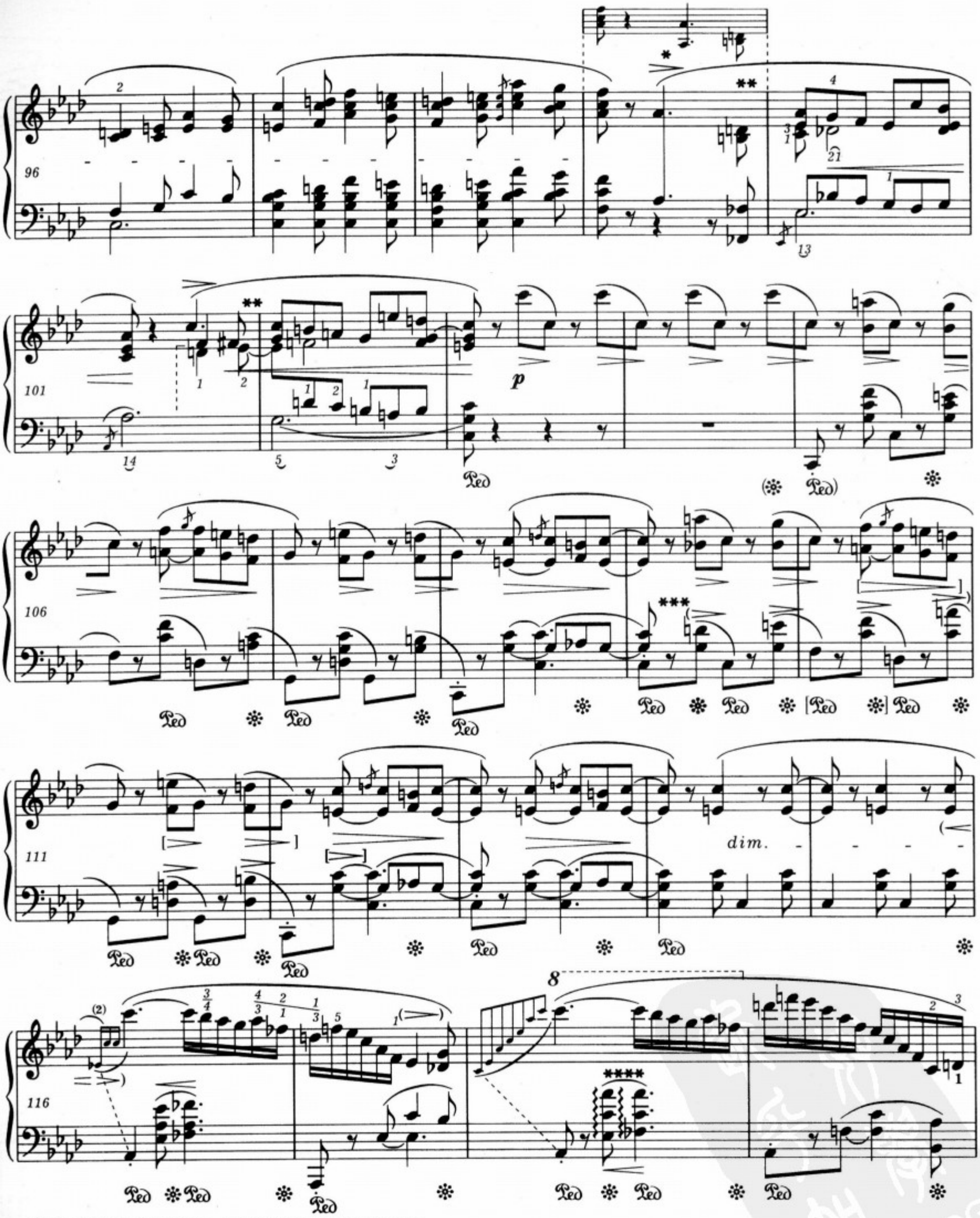
86

dim.

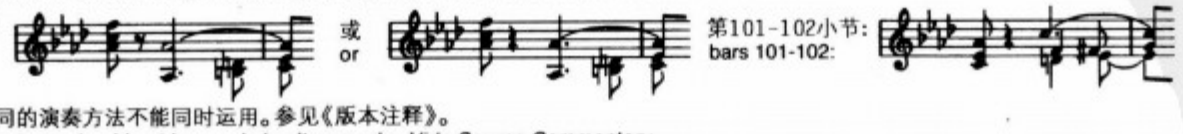
p

91

dim.

cresc.

* 有些版本存在两种不同的节奏方法，但是写得并不清楚。参见《版本注释》。
The main text and the variant contain two ways of reading the rhythmic record of the text, unclear in the sources. *Vide Source Commentary.*

** 或：*ossia:* 第99-100小节：bars 99-100: 或 or 第101-102小节：bars 101-102:



这些不同的演奏方法不能同时运用。参见《版本注释》。
These variants should not be used simultaneously. *Vide Source Commentary.*

*** 肖邦在某个学生用谱中，在第109-112小节左手上方音符弹奏重音的段落加有连线。
In one of the pupils' copies, Chopin slurred a phrase created by the accented L.H. top notes in bars 109-112.

**** *a♭'*音要重复。
The note *a♭'* should be repeated.

120

124

leggiero

127

130

dim.

133

cresc.

sostenuto

* $e\flat'$音要重复。
The note $e\flat'$ should be repeated.

137

140

8

ten.

ten.

cresc.

143

p

147

152

·和第109-112小节一样,第150-153小节在两份学生用谱中加有连线。
In bars 150-153 two pupils' copies contain a slur added by Chopin, as in bars 109-112.

157

mezza voce

legato

160

163

cresc. - - -

166

169

172

8

ff

175

178

8

181

(1)

(2)

(5 4)

184

fz

p

• 一个允许的奏法：
A permissible variant, based on the earlier version:

参见《版本注释》。
Vide Source Commentary.

smorzando

sotto voce

187

190

193

196

ossia:

199

202

cresc.

205

208

211

ff

215

220

224

stretto

cresc.

228

più mosso

232

236

* ♭a¹音要重复。
The note ♭a¹ should be repeated.

叙事曲
Ballade

献给罗斯吉德男爵夫人
A Madame Nathaniel de Rothschild

Andante con moto

op. 52

legato

p

dim.

ritenuto

in tempo

mezza voce

* 一个允许的奏法，和第30小节一样。
A permissible variant, as in bar 30.

19

23

27

31

35

dim.

pp

legato

39

43

mezza voce

47

23

tr

51

54

ten.

58

cresc.

61

f

cresc.

64

67

ritenuto

70

ff

fz

in tempo

73

dim. - accel.

76

leggiero

rite-

79

nuto

in tempo

p

83

dolce

87

* 参见《版本注释》。
Vide Source Commentary.

** 肖邦加的指法：音符上方表示用右手，下方表示用左手。
Fingering by Chopin: over the notes it refers to the R. H., and below the notes - to the L.H.

92

Ped (Ped

97

ritardando

a tempo

cresc.

Ped Ped Ped

101

cresc.

Ped Ped Ped

104

cresc.

Ped Ped

107

ritenuto

in tempo

Ped Ped

• 早期版本，可视为另一种演奏版本：
An earlier version which should be recognized as a variant:

•• 参见《版本注释》。
Vide Source Commentary.

110

ten.

leggiero

tr

tr

113

ten.

tr

tr

116

8

f dim.

119

tr

34

122

cresc.

125

f

ten.

(ten.)

ten.

128

-dim.

pp

(ritardando)

131

smorzando

134

dolciss.

rallent.

135

legato

p a tempo

139

143

147

151

154

156

(158)

161

163

cresc.

accel.

165

dim.

• 有一个版本 $a\flat^2$ 没有用连线保持，也许有错误。
One of the sources, maybe erroneously, has no tie sustaining the $a\flat^2$.

167

169

p *leggiero* *in tempo*

171

173

dolce

175

177

f

fz

179

Ped

181

Ped Ped Ped Ped

183

Ped Ped Ped Ped

185

Ped Ped Ped Ped

187 cresc.

189

191 fz cresc.

193

195 fz ff

198

stretto

202

fff

pp

211

f

213

215

fz

fz

fz

217

marcato

219

221

223

ff

225

• 在某版本中该组三个音如下：
The authenticity of the following version of this triplet in one of the sources:

准确性不可知。参见《版本注释》。
remains uncertain. *Vide Source Commentary.*

** 参见《演奏注释》。
Vide Performance Commentary.

accel. sin al fine

227

fz

p

cresc.

229

231

ff

233

(235)

弗雷德里克·肖邦
叙事曲

《演奏注释》
《版本注释》(精简本)

FRYDERYK CHOPIN
BALLADES

Performance Commentary
Source Commentary (abridged)

PERFORMANCE COMMENTARY

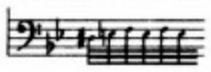
Notes on the musical text

The variants marked as *ossia* were given this label by Chopin or were added in his hand to pupils' copies; variants without this designation are the result of discrepancies in the texts of authentic versions or an inability to establish an unambiguous reading of the text.
Minor authentic alternatives (single notes, ornaments, slurs, accents, pedal indications etc.) that can be regarded as variants are enclosed in round brackets (), whilst editorial additions are written in square brackets [].
Pianists who are not interested in editorial questions, and want to base their performance on a single text, unhampered by variants, are recommended to use the music printed in the principal staves, including all the markings in brackets.
Chopin's original fingering is indicated in large bold-type numerals, **1 2 3 4 5**, in contrast to the editors' fingering which is written in small italic numerals *1 2 3 4 5*. Wherever authentic fingering is enclosed in parentheses this means that it was not present in the primary sources but added by Chopin to his pupils' copies.
A general discussion on the interpretation of Chopin's works is to be contained in a separate volume: *The Introduction to the National Edition,* in the section entitled *Problems of Performance.*

Abbreviations: R.H. — right hand, L.H. — left hand.

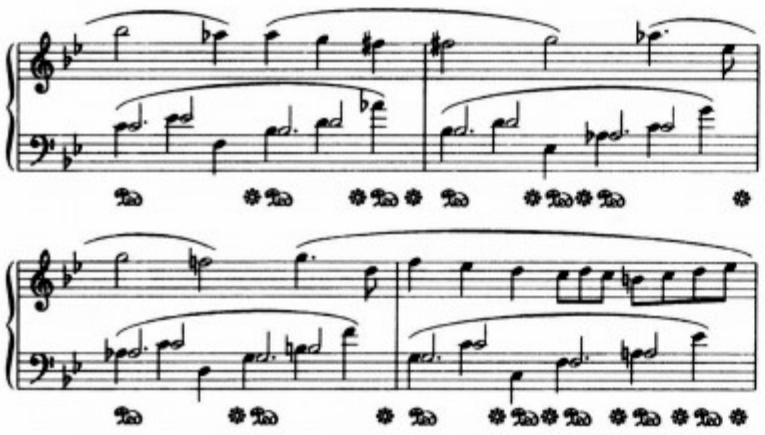
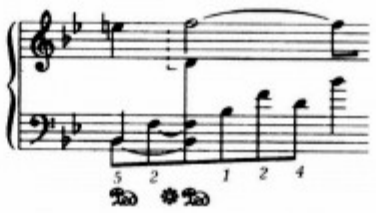
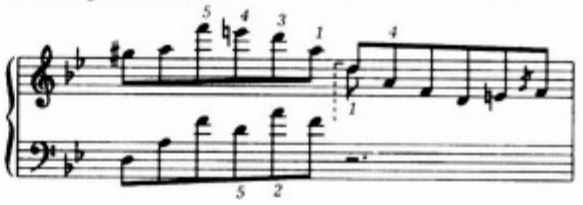
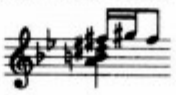
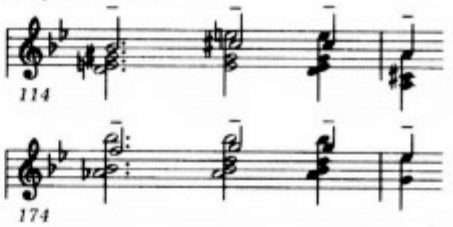
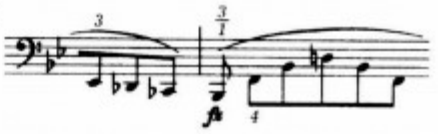
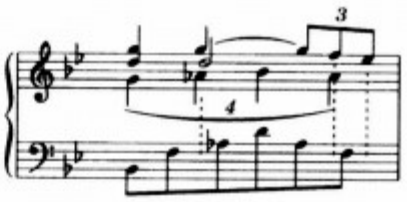
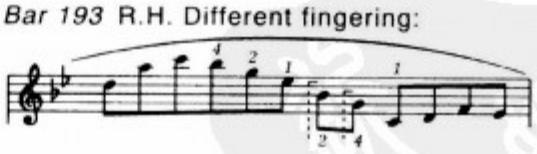
1. Ballade in G minor, Op. 23

p. 12 *Bar 25* L.H. The start of the trill with grace-notes:



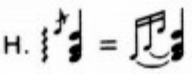
. $d\sharp$ simultaneously with g' in the R.H.

Bar 32 R.H. The arpeggio should be started together with the octave in the L.H.

p. 14 *Bars 72-75* In order to avoid an excessive mingling of melodic notes and retain complete harmony, which would be ensured by Chopinesque pedalling, the latter can be somewhat modified by a simultaneous application of a "harmonic legato" in the L.H. (fingers sustain the harmonic notes):

p. 16 *Bar 92* On modern pianos this bar is best executed with one pedal since the mingling of melodic notes e^2 and f^2 is less jarring than losing the basic notes *B* and *f* while changing the pedal on the third quaver. Pianists with a larger hand span can use the following technique, which makes it possible to retain full harmony and a clean rendering of the melody:

Bar 93 A different fingering of this bar could be the result of the original text:

p. 17 *Bar 113* R.H. Execution of the chord with grace-notes:

Bars 114 and 174 R.H. The melody of the theme should be emphasized:

p. 20 *Bar 166* $f\sharp^2$ on the first note is obtained easier by playing with the R.H.:

p. 21 *Bar 179* R.H. tr = $\sim\sim$.
R.H. Judging by the alignment of the notes in the autograph (reproduced in our edition) and the approximate calculation of rhythmic values, the second half of the bar is best executed as follows:

p. 22 *Bar 193* R.H. Different fingering:

p. 25 *Bar 246* L.H. The arpeggio should be executed in an anticipatory manner i.e. g' simultaneously with $e\flat^4$ in the R.H.

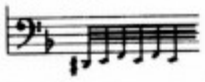
Bar 258-259 The marking of the breaking of the octaves first with grace-notes and then with the help of diagonal lines indicates a gradual acceleration of the break, parallel to the *poco ritenuto — accelerando* marking, so that together with the start of bar 260 it would be possible to imperceptibly enter into ideally simultaneous and rapid octaves.

2. Ballade in F major, Op. 38

p. 26 *Bars 19, 21, 41, 93 and 95* R.H.  =

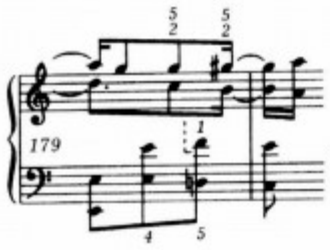
The first note of the arpeggio (in bar 19 c^1) should be struck simultaneously with the appropriate note in the L.H.

p. 31 *Bar 118* A sign to execute *f♯* with the L.H. comes from the editors.

p. 33 *Bar 165* L.H. The start of the trill with grace-notes:

D♯ simultaneously with the first semiquaver in the R.H.

p. 34 *Bars 172 and 176* R.H. Facilitation:

. Analogously in bar 176.

Bars 179 and 183 L.H. Facilitation for a smaller hand:

. Analogously in bar 183.

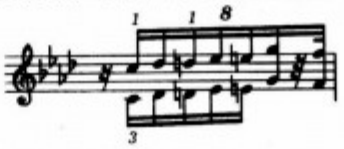
p. 35 *Bar 197* A pianistically convenient and sonorically expressive realization of the beginning of the bar:

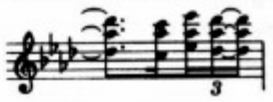
Bar 203 R.H. Simultaneously with the octave in the L.H., the grace-note should be played, and in case the version without the grace-note is selected — the first note of the arpeggio should be struck.

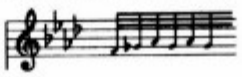
3. Ballade in A flat major, Op. 47

p. 36 *Bars 3 and 39* L.H. The grace-note (or in the variant the first note of the mordent) should be struck simultaneously with the R.H. chord.

Bars 9, 10 and analogously The original pedalling seems to indicate the fact that Chopin wished to retain the sound of the fundamental bass note also in the second half of the bars despite the changing harmonies. On modern pianos the retention of the bass notes without blurring the harmonies can be attained by rapidly changing the pedal in the middle of the bar. The bass notes can be also sustained with the use of a third (sostenuto) pedal.

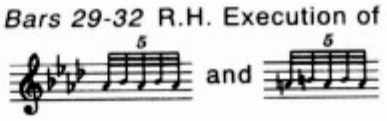
Bar 14 R.H. Facilitation of the second half of the bar:

Using this facilitation, care should be taken so that the sound effect is close to the sonority resulting from the execution of the octaves in the R.H. alone, as foreseen by Chopin: not too rapidly and with suitable articulation — *legato* for the upper notes and *non legato* for the lower ones.

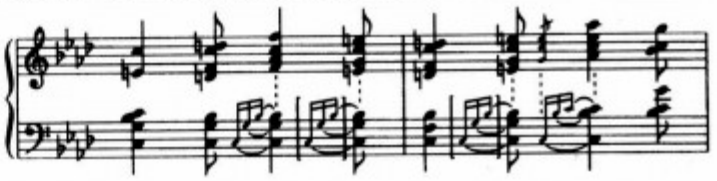
Bar 22 R.H. In the opinion of the editors the best execution of the chord grace-note is:

p. 37 *Bars 26 and 28* R.H. The start of the trill in bar 26:



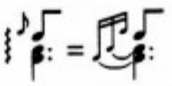
f^1 together with the L.H. chord. Analogously in bar 28.

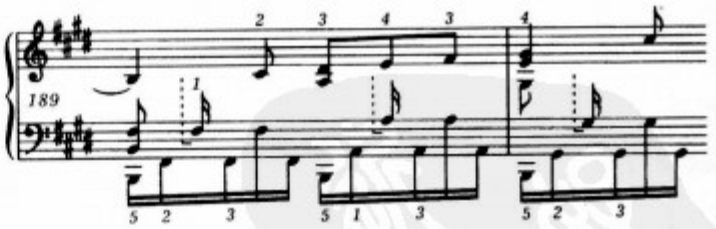
Bars 29-32 R.H. Execution of trills:



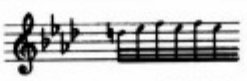
p. 40 *Bars 97-98* A different division of chords between two hands:

The arpeggiation of certain chords emulates their execution in the original division into hands (the inclusion of arpeggios in brackets is left to the discretion of the performer).

p. 41 *Bar 136* R.H. The grace-note $e\flat^2$ should be struck together with $E\flat$ in the L.H.

p. 42 *Bar 139* R.H.  Playing the lower note of the arpeggio together with the first L.H. semiquaver is more in keeping with Chopin's style.

p. 45 *Bars 189-190 and 197-198* L.H. Facilitation for smaller hands:

Analogously in bars 197-198.

Bars 190 and 198 R.H. The grace-note should be struck simultaneously with the first semiquaver of the second half of the bar in the L.H.

p. 47 *Bars 235 and 236* R.H. The start of the trill in bar 235:

d^2 together with the L.H. sixth. Analogously in bar 236.

4. Ballade in F minor, Op. 52

p. 48 *Bar 1* R.H. The fact that Chopin placed the marking *legato* between the R.H. voices can denote only a "harmonic legato" — in this case the retention of the notes c^2 as was marked for the accompanying seconds and thirds in bars 2 and 4.

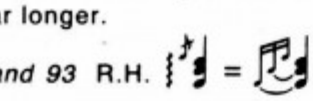
Bars 4, 131 and 132 R.H. The lower note of the arpeggios should be played simultaneously with the L.H.

p. 49 *Bars 38-45* On modern pianos the pedal depressed at the beginning of bars 38 and 42 can be sustained longer (at least by half a bar), and then a pedal changed on each quaver should be added.

p. 51 *Bars 61 and 65* R.H. The arpeggios should be started together with an appropriate L.H. note.

Bar 65 A sign to execute $g\flat^1$ with the R.H. comes from the editors.

p. 52 *Bars 74-77* On modern pianos the pedal can be sustained at least a bar longer.

Bars 85 and 93 R.H.  , $b\flat$ together with the L.H. crotchet.

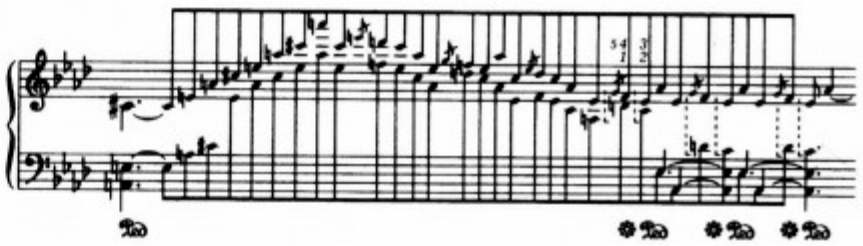
p. 53 *Bar 104* L.H. The depression of the pedal immediately after the third semiquaver makes it possible for even the smallest hand to sustain the $G\sharp$ fundamental bass note without mingling the melodic semitones.

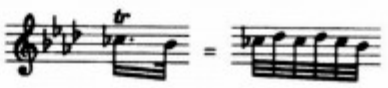
p. 54 *Bars 112 and 114* L.H. The realization of trills in bar 112:

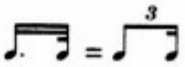
. Analogously in bar 114.

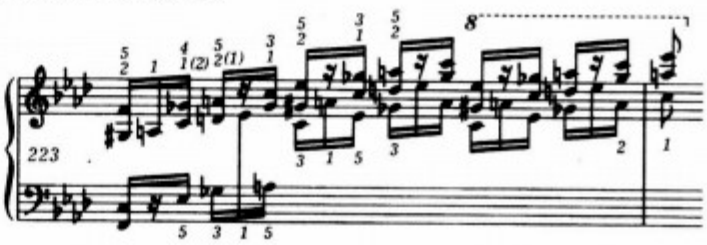
p. 55 *Bar 128* Taking b into the L.H. is an editorial suggestion.

Bar 134 At the end of the cadenza it is possible to retain the sonority of the basis of harmony, the *A*-*e* fifth, without mingling the notes $c\sharp^1$-d^1-e^1-f^1 with a single pedal:



p. 57 *Bar 161* R.H.

p. 58 *Bar 173* R.H. The grace-note f^1 before the arpeggio should be sounded simultaneously with $D\flat$ in the L.H.

p. 60 *Bar 191 sqq.* 

p. 62 *Bars 223 and 225* The Ignaz Friedmann, Alfred Cortot and Alfred Casella editions contain a variant of fingering worthy of recommendation:

Jan Ekier
Paweł Kamiński

SOURCE COMMENTARY /ABRIDGED/

Introductory remarks

The following commentary sets out in an abridged form the principles of editing the musical text of particular works and discusses the most important discrepancies between the authentic sources; furthermore, it draws attention to unauthentic versions which are most frequently encountered in the collected editions of Chopin's music compiled after his death. A separately published *Source Commentary* contains a detailed description of the sources, their filiation, justification of the choice of primary sources, a thorough presentation of the differences between them and a reproduction of characteristic fragments.

Remark to the second edition

This edition of the Ballades took into consideration sources inaccessible during work on the first edition (PWM, Kraków 1967), predominantly: a fragment of the editorial autograph of the *Ballade in F minor*, Op. 52 and copies of different impressions of the first French editions* of all the *Ballades*, making it possible to follow their correction by Chopin. This fact enabled a more certain establishment of the text and the reduction of the number of variants. In comparison to the first edition of *Source Commentaries* (PWM, Kraków 1970), data concerning sources and their filiation have been brought up to date (i.a. the numeration of the impressions of the first editions has been altered).

Abbreviations: R.H. — right hand, L.H. — left hand. The sign → symbolizes a connection between sources; it should be read "and ... based on it".

1. Ballade in G minor, Op. 23

Sources

A Autograph/fair-copy (private collection, photocopy in the Chopin Society, Warsaw). **A** served as the basis for the first French edition.

FE1 First French edition, M. Schlesinger (M.S. 1928), Paris VII 1836. **FE1** was based on **A** and contains numerous changes introduced by Chopin during the proof-reading.

FE2 The second impression of **FE1**, VIII 1836, perfunctorily corrected by Chopin.

FE = **FE1** and **FE2**.

FED Collection of copies of **FE** belonging to Chopin's pupil Camille Dubois, with annotations by Chopin (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris), containing fingerings, performance indications, variants and corrections of printing errors.

GE1 First German edition, Breitkopf & Härtel (5706), Leipzig VI 1836. **GE1** repeated (with errors) the **FE1** version, introducing its own revisions. We cannot exclude the possibility that some of the changes in **GE1** come from Chopin.

GE2, **GE3**, **GE4** — further impressions of **GE1**, successively introducing unauthentic changes and supplements.

GE = **GE1**, **GE2**, **GE3** and **GE4**.

EE First English edition, Wessel & C° (W & C° 1644), London V 1836. **EE** was based on **FE1** and was not corrected by Chopin.

Editorial Principles

We have accepted as our basis **FE2** as the last authentic source, compared with **A**.

p. 11 *Bar 1* **A** (→**FE**→**EE**) has **Largo** as the tempo marking. The **Lento** in **GE** could have been added by Chopin to the **FE1** copy serving as the basis for **GE**.

Bar 7 L.H. The top note in **A** (→**FE**→**EE**) is $e\flat^1$, and in **GE** — d^1. This ambiguity gave rise to doubts already during Chopin's lifetime. The **GE** version could be either a revision of this edition (*cf.* commentary to bars 45 and 47) or a variant introduced by Chopin (to avoid parallel fifths in upper voices?, together with **Lento**? — *vide* commentary to bar 1). Long after the death of Chopin, Saint-Saëns stated that he deduced from Liszt's elusive response that Chopin played d^1. Nonetheless, apart from such certain sources as **A** and **FE**, twice corrected by Chopin, testimonies of four persons closely connected with Chopin (Marcelina Czartoryska, Friederike Streicher, Ferdinand Hiller and Adolf Gutmann) speak in favour of the version with $e\flat^1$.

p. 12 *Bar 26-27* R.H. In **FE** (→**GE**, **EE**) the tie which in **A** sustains the minim d^2 to the next bar has been mistakenly deciphered as a phrasing slur and joined to the slur over bars 27-28.

p. 13 *Bars 45 and 47* R.H. Before the first quaver in both bars **GE** has ♯. This is an arbitrary addition made by the reviser of **GE** (*cf.* commentary to the *Ballade in F minor* Op. 52, bars 164 and 165).

p. 14 *Bar 63* R.H. The last quaver in **GE** is mistakenly *d*. Probably the engraver mistook this bar for one of the similar bars 57, 59 or 61-62 (such errors were committed elsewhere in **GE**: d^1 instead of c^1 on the first note of the second half of bar 100 and e^1 instead of d^1 on the fourth crotchet in the L.H. in bar 114). The version with *c* in **A** (→**FE**→**EE**) prepares harmony in bar 64 in a manner characteristic for Chopin, avoiding the suspension of the *d* sound, absent in this harmony.

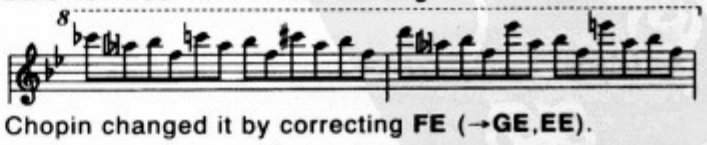
p. 16 *Bar 99* R.H. On the fifth and sixth crotchet **A** has the chord e^1-a^1-c^2. Chopin removed both e^1 in the proofs of **FE1** (→**GE**, **EE**).

Bars 103-105 L.H. On the last beat **A** has in each of these bars a rest instead of the chord *e*-*a*-c^1. We give the version Chopin introduced in the proofs of **FE1** (→**GE**,**EE**). The majority of the later collected editions give an unauthentic compiled version of those bars: bars 103-104 in the original sonority (with a rest) but bar 105 with an arpeggiated chord of the final version.

p. 17 *Bars 119 and 123* R.H. In **A** there are no chromatic signs over the mordents in these bars. In the proofs of **FE1** Chopin added ♯ over ∾ in bar 123. The majority of the later collected editions, assuming the possibility of an oversight, also added ♯ in bar 119. There are no arguments, however, in favour of an oversight by Chopin. The mordent with the semitone g^2 in bar 119 better corresponds to the scale octave progression in B-minor and the analogous melodic-tonal situation in bar 121. On the other hand, the whole-tonal ∾ in bar 123 ($g\sharp^2$-$a\sharp^2$) signalizes modulation changes in that particular bar and following bars.

p. 18 *Bars 126 and 136* **A** has *sempre più animato* in bar 126 and *più vivo* in bar 136. We give the reduced — probably by Chopin — markings in **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**).

Bars 134-135 R.H. **A** has the original version:



Chopin changed it by correcting **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**).

Bar 137 R.H. Before the fifth quaver **A** has ♮, removed by Chopin in the proofs of **FE1** (→**GE**,**EE**).

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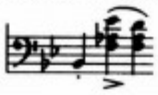
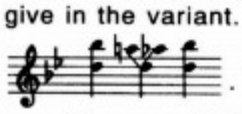
* The inclusion of this group of sources into editorial work was made possible thanks to the research and assistance of Dr. Krzysztof **Grabowski** from Paris.

p. 19 *Bar 145* L.H. The original version of the first half of the bar in **A**: . Chopin changed it in **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**).

p. 20 *Bar 171* R.H. **A** (→**FE1**→**GE**,**EE**) has a version which we give in the variant. In **FE2** it was changed into the following:  . The alterations were conducted certainly upon the request of Chopin but it is doubtful whether it was his intention to leave d^2 in the last but one crotchet of the quintuplet. The erroneous double engraving of the shifted note is encountered upon several occasions in the first French editions of Chopin's works (e.g. the *Scherzo in B minor* Op. 20, bars 135 and 292, the *Polonaise in A* Op. 40 No. 1, second version, bar 93). Hence in the main text we give a version of **FE2** corrected by Chopin, emended analogously to bar 170.

p. 21 *Bar 173* R.H. The main text comes from **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**), the variant — from **A**. The crossing-out in **A** testify to Chopin's indecision as regards the two possibilities; similar variants are encountered in his other works (e.g. the *Ballade in A♭*, Op. 47, bars 3 and 39).

p. 22 *Bar 193* R.H. **GE3** arbitrarily changes the sixth quaver from $e♭^2$ to d^2.
R.H. The last quaver in **A** is mistakenly d^1. Chopin corrected it to $e♭^1$ in the proofs of **FE1** (→**GE**,**EE**).

Bars 194, 196 and 198 R.H. The accents in the form of short lines, rarely used by Chopin, were written by him into **FE**D.

p. 23 *Bar 214* L.H. At the beginning of the bar **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**) has the a-c^1-g^1 triad. **A** is not very legible at this point but there are no clear reasons for differentiating this bar and bar 210, with an indubitable four-note chord (with $e♭^1$).

Bar 223 L.H. At the end of this bar **FE** (→**GE**, **EE**) has an a-d^1 fourth. This is probably an error caused by the indistinct record of this crotchet in **A**. A comparison with the harmonically similar bar 217 and analogous ones speaks in favour of the a-c^1-d^1 chord.

p. 24 *Bar 229* L.H. The majority of the later collected editions arbitrarily adds $b♭$ to the authentic g on the last crotchet.

p. 25 *Bar 259* Diagonal lines indicating the breaking of octaves in the second half of the bar (*cf. Performance Commentary*) were omitted in **FE** (→**GE**,**EE**).

2. Ballade in F major, Op. 38

Sources

A Autograph/fair-copy which served as the basis for the first French edition and then the first English edition (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris).

GC Copy, probably by Gutmann, which served as the basis for the first German edition (Stiftelsen Musikkulturens Främjande, Stockholm). In **GC** the copyist committed numerous errors and imprecisions. In a probably hurried examination, Chopin introduced a number of supplementations and corrections.

FE1 First French edition, E. Troupenas (T. 925), Paris X 1840. **FE1** was based on **A**, contained a considerable number of errors (i.a. in slurring) and was not corrected by Chopin.

FE2 The second impression of **FE1** (the same firm and number), corrected by Chopin.

FE3 The third impression of **FE1** (the same firm and number), which introduced, above all, numerous and, as a rule, obvious supplementations of accidentals. Chopin most probably did not participate in its production.

FE = **FE1**, **FE2** and **FE3**.

FED As in the *Ballade in G minor*, Op. 23.

FES,**FE**J — collections of pupils' copies of **FE** with annotations by Chopin, containing fingering, performance directives, variants, and corrections of printing errors.
FES — collection belonging to Chopin's pupil, Jane Stirling (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris),
FEJ — collection belonging to Chopin's sister, Ludwika Jędrzejowiczowa (Chopin Society, Warsaw).

EE First English edition, Wessel & C° (W & C° 3182), London X 1840. **EE** was based on **A** and was not corrected by Chopin.

GE1 First German edition, Breitkopf & Härtel (6330), Leipzig X 1840. **GE1** was based on G**C** and was not corrected by Chopin. There are copies of **GE1** with different prices on the covers.

GE2 Second German edition (the same firm and number), after 1852, with small adjustments of the text of **GE1**.

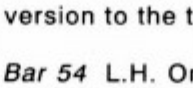
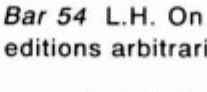
GE = **GE1** and **GE2**.

Editorial Principles

We have based our text on **A** and taken into consideration changes introduced by Chopin to G**C** and **FE2** as well as his additions to pupils' copies.

p. 26 *Bars 26-27* R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily tie g^1 notes over bar-line.

p. 27 *Bars 37-38* R.H. Analogously to bars 91-92 some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add notes e^1 on the last quaver of bar 37 and at the beginning of bar 38.

p. 28 *Bar 53* R.H. The original beginning of the bar was:  . Already in **A** (→**FE**,**EE**) Chopin altered it to:  . In G**C** (→**GE**) Chopin changed this second version to the text which we present.

Bar 54 L.H. On the fourth quaver some of the later collected editions arbitrarily changed the A_1-A octave to C-c.

p. 30 *Bar 93* R.H. **A** (→**FE**,**EE**) has no arpeggio which is found in G**C** (→**GE**), probably added by Chopin.

Bar 98-99 R.H. **A** (→**FE**,**EE**) has no tie sustaining $g♭^1$. Chopin added it in G**C** (→**GE**).

Bars 101,107,126 and 132 R.H. In the second half of the bars it is difficult to ascertain the sonority of the third in the lower voice intended by Chopin. **A** (→**FE1**,**EE**) has the version presented in our edition. In G**C** (→**GE**) Chopin added ♮ in bar 126, changing $b♭$-d^1 to b-d^1. In the proofs of **FE2** Chopin added ♭ in bar 132, changing e^1-g^1 to $e♭^1$-g^1. Below we present a list of thirds (major or minor) in particular sources:

bar	101	107	126	132
1. **A**	major	minor	major	minor
2. G**C**	major	minor	minor	minor
3. **FE2**	major	minor	major	major.

This table shows that:
— none of the sources contains an identical version in all bars
— the presumption that while correcting G**C** or **FE2** Chopin intended to unify those passages leads to a contradiction since in G**C** he altered the major third to a minor one, and in

FE2 the minor third to a major one
— accepting that a differentiation of those bars corresponds to Chopin's intentions, we must recognise version 1 as the most perfect one. The remaining versions are probably the result of Chopin's errors due to a hurried and fragmentary proof-reading of those greatly similar passages.
Some of the later collected editions, whose point of departure is the second version, arbitrarily change the major third in bar 101 to a minor one, and give a reduced, identical version in all four bars.

Bar 105 R.H. In the second half of the bar some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add $a♭^1$ to the f^1 of the lower voice.

Bar 106 R.H. The main text comes from **FE**2 in which Chopin corrected the incomplete and erroneous version of **FE**1. The variant is the **A** version; it is not clear whether it was Chopin's intention to sustain $g♭^1$ (as in **EE**) or to repeat it (G**C**→**GE**).

Bars 110-111 R.H. At the end of bar 110 **A** (→**FE**1,**EE**) has octaves $g♯^2$-$g♯^3$ and a^2-a^3. Chopin supplemented them with e^3 notes both in G**C** (**GE** mistakenly reads f^3 in the last quaver) and in the proofs of **FE**2. This corrected version, in which the passage from a four-note chord in the middle of the bar to an octave in bar 111, rendered smooth thanks to three-note chords, is presented by us as the main version. In the variant, however, we cite the original **A** version since the false relation between e^3 in bar 110 and the E♭ octaves in bar 111 is less audible. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add $e♭^3$ to the octave at the beginning of bar 111.

Bars 111-112 L.H. Octaves $B♭_1$-$B♭$ are tied between the bars in **A** (→G**C**→**GE**, →**FE**1,**EE**). In the proofs of **FE**2 Chopin removed the ties, probably in order to achieve rhythmic analogy with bars 136-137. The ties were subsequently restored in **FE**3, but probably not by Chopin himself but by the reviser who in this impression checked the slurs and ties according to **A**. We thus present the **FE**2 version, undoubtedly corrected by Chopin, as the main version.

p. 31 *Bars 123-124 and 129-130* R.H. The majority of later collected editions joins notes f^1 in bars 123-124 and $b♭^1$ in bars 129-130 analogously to bars 98-99 and 104-105. Nothing, however, indicates that Chopin wanted a strict analogy between bars 99-108 and 124-133.

Bars 125-126 L.H. Sources do not lengthen *G* to bar 126 (no note and tie). This is certainly Chopin's oversight connected with the fact that bar 126 begins a new page in **A**. *Cf.* analogous bars 101,107 and 132.

Bar 133 R.H. In **A** (→G**C**→**GE**, →**FE**1,**EE**) the semiquaver is only the g^1-g^2 octave. In the proofs of **FE**2 Chopin supplemented it with the note c^2.

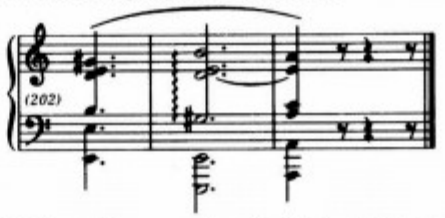
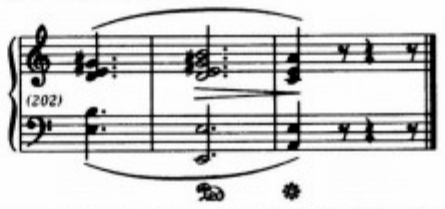
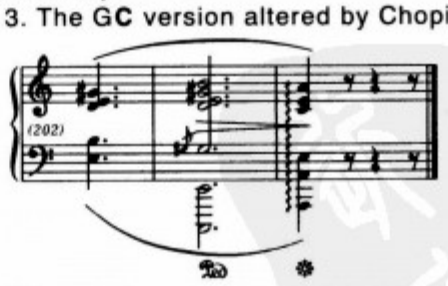
Bar 139 R.H. **FE** overlooks $b♭^1$ in the third chord of the bar.

p. 32 *Bar 148* R.H. The upper note in the first semiquaver in **A** (→**FE**,**EE**) is e^1 (our main text). In G**C** this note was altered but it is difficult to say whether the mistakenly written f^1 was corrected to e^1 by Chopin or the copyist, or, on the contrary, whether Chopin altered the correctly copied e^1 to f^1 (as understood in **GE**, our variant). Numerous errors and imprecision of the copyist as well as the absence of an accent over this note, while the f^1 four semiquavers earlier and later are accented, speak in favour of the first possibility (e^1).
L.H. **FE** overlooks ties sustaining the $G♯_1$-$G♯$ octave.

p. 33 *Bars 169 and 173* R.H. There is no accidental before the lower note of the first sixth in the second half of the bar in **A** as well as in G**C** and **FE**, both corrected by Chopin. This means that Chopin wanted to have $d♯^1$ in bar 169 and $d♯^2$ in bar 173. The revisers of **EE** in bar 169 and **GE** in bar 173 added ♮ next to those notes, perhaps misled by an unnecessary natural next to b^2 in bar 173.

p. 34 *Bar 173* L.H. In **A** (→G**C**→**GE**, →**FE**1,**EE**) the second quaver is the c^1-f^1 fourth. This error was corrected by Chopin in the proofs of **FE**2.

p. 35 *Bar 196* Before the notes $b♭$, $b♭^2$, $b♭^3$ in the second half of the bar **A** (→G**C**→**GE**1, →**FE**1→**FE**2) has no accidentals and thus the flats from the first half of the bar are binding. The crossing-out of the sign, visible in **A** and G**C**, before the lower note of the L.H. chord (G**C** shows that this was ♭) also proves that Chopin checked the correctness of the script in both manuscripts. The revisers of **EE**, **FE**3 and **GE**2 added naturals before these notes (b, b^2 and b^3), making this chord similar to two previous ones (in bars 195-196). The authentic version of the chord (f-a♭-b♭-d) avoids a mechanical repetition of a diminished seventh chord in three parts of the sequence; in this version, the climax chord in bar 197 is more expressive thanks to three notes, new in relation to the previous chord.

Bars 202-204 The several versions of the end of the *Ballade* testify to Chopin's undecidedness. In chronological order they are:
1. The original version in **A**

2. The later version in **A** (→**EE**), added by Chopin underneath the crossed out first version

This version was copied in G**C** where Chopin then modified it; it is also contained in **FE**1 (with a mistaken c^1 instead of d^1 in bar 203).
3. The G**C** version altered by Chopin

This version was adopted in **GE**, correcting the lower note in bar 203 and adding a mistaken tie joining the grace-note and minim $g♯$.
4. The **FE**2 version corrected by Chopin

These four versions are divided into two pairs with a different range of the chords: "open" versions 1 and 3 and "close" versions 2 and 4. It is highly probable that it was precisely the wavering between the "open" ending, corresponding to the whole *Ballade*, and the "close" one, which did not transcend beyond the atmosphere of the few last bars (from *tempo primo*), that was the cause of so many changes in this fragment.

Among the "open" versions, version 3 is later than version 1 but it contains a mistaken pitch (C_1 instead of E_1 in bar 203) and three distinct stylistic lapses:

— the doubling of the leading-note $g\sharp$-$g\sharp'$ in bar 203

— the absence of the resolution of $g\sharp$ to a

— a double-octave leap of the bass from e in bar 202 to E_1 in bar 203.

The following conclusion comes to mind: inasmuch as the very fact of corrections conducted by Chopin in G**C** is the expression of his unquestioned intention to pass from a "close" version to an "open" one, the result of those corrections, which is probably due to the hurried manner of their introduction, cannot be acknowledged as definitive. The "open" version, which best reflects Chopin's intention, is, therefore, the version 1.

Among the "close" versions, version 4, introduced by Chopin into the proofs of **FE**2 in place of version 2, should be regarded as definitive.

Our edition takes into consideration Chopin's uncertainty by presenting two basic versions (1 and 4). For the main text we have accepted the "open" version (enhanced with a variant grace-note, characteristic for Chopin, and added in G**C**) which corresponds to the *Ballade* as a whole, since while changing the "close" version in the proofs of **FE**2 Chopin could have felt constrained in introducing in print excessively far reaching alterations.

3. Ballade in A flat major, Op. 47

Sources

A Autograph/fair-copy (lost, photocopy in the Chopin Society in Warsaw). Fontana used **A** to make a copy intended as the basis for the first French edition. Subsequently, **A** served as the basis for the first German edition.

[FC] Lost copy by Fontana, made upon the basis of **A**. [**FC**] served as the basis for the first French edition. Superficial proof--reading by Chopin is not excluded.

SC Copy by Saint-Saëns (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris), made upon the basis of [**FC**] compared with the first French edition. **SC** makes possible an almost complete reconstruction of [**FC**].

GE1 First German edition, Breitkopf & Härtel (6652), Leipzig I 1842. **GE**1 was based on **A** and was not corrected by Chopin.

GE2 Second impression of **GE**1 (the same firm and number) after 1870, correcting part of the errors in **GE**1 and introducing a number of changes (some according to **FE**, others arbitrarily).

FE1 First French edition, M. Schlesinger (M.S. 3486), Paris XI 1841. **FE**1 was based on [**FC**] and corrected by Chopin.

FE2 Second impression of **FE**1 (the same firm and number), also corrected by Chopin.

FE = **FE**1 and **FE**2.

FED As in the *Ballade in G minor*, Op. 23.

FES, FEJ — as in the *Ballade in F*, Op. 38.

FESch — a copy of **FE** with annotations by Chopin, from a collection belonging to Chopin's pupil, Marie de Scherbatoff (Houghton Library, New York). Contains fingering, a variant and a corrected printing error.

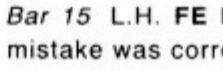
EE First English edition, Wessel & Stapleton (W & S 5299), London I 1842. **EE** was based on **FE**2 and was not corrected by Chopin.

Editorial Principles

We have based our text on **FE**2 as the last authentic source compared with **A** in order to eliminate the numerous errors and oversights of the engravers. We take into consideration Chopin's annotations in four pupils' copies.

p. 36 *Bars 3 and 39* L.H.. In **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**) the note $b\flat$ starting the second half of the bar is marked with a mordent (which in bar 39 is indicated as *tr*). **FE**1 contains no ornaments, a fact which Chopin corrected in **FE**2 (→**EE**), adding grace-notes which make it possible to achieve the legato in this phrase easier than do the mordents. This type of variants is encountered several times in Chopin's works e.g. in the *Ballade in G minor* Op. 23, bar 173 or the *Mazurka in C♯ minor* Op. 41 No. 4, bars 97-101.

Bars 6-7 L.H. In **A** a tie holding the $e\flat$ is found only in bar 7 which starts the new line. The absence of the tie in bar 6 could be an oversight on the part of Chopin (this is the way it was understood by [**FC**]→**FE**→**EE**). It cannot be completely excluded that it was the tie in bar 7 which was introduced mistakenly (it is absent in **GE**).

Bar 15 L.H. **FE** has an erroneous rhythm  . This mistake was corrected by Chopin in **FE**S and **FE**J.

Bar 21 L.H. The last chord in **FE**1 is f-$a\flat$-c^1-f^1. Correcting this error, **FE**2 mistakenly left only the octave f-f^1.

p. 38 *Bar 46* L.H. Instead of c^2-$e\flat^2$ **FE**(→**EE**) mistakenly has $a\flat^1$-c^2.

Bars 47-49 The *ossia* variant was added by Chopin in **FE**J.

p. 39 *Bar 71* R.H. The main text comes from **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**1), the variant — from **FE** (→**EE**,**GE**2). We give priority to the **A** version since it is not certain whether the $a\flat^1$ in **FE** was added in proof-reading by Chopin himself (it is possible that an error was committed by the engraver), while the authenticity of the **A** version does not give rise to doubts.

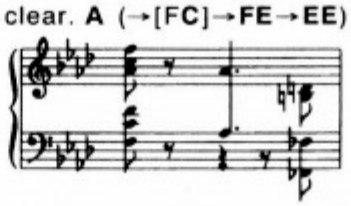
Bar 74 L.H. On the last quaver we give the fourth $a\flat$-$d\flat^1$, as in **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**). In **FE** (→**EE**) there is an added *f*. This note has no natural continuation in the next bar (in contrast to bars 76-77 where it passes to e), in this way deforming the line $b\flat$-$a\flat$-g-$a\flat$-$b\flat$-$a\flat$-g-f-e of the lower chord notes in bars 73-77. Probably the engraver of **FE** mistook this bar for bar 76.

Bar 83 L.H. It does not follow clearly from the script of **A** whether the last chord is to have three notes ($e\flat$-$a\flat$-$e\flat^1$), as was interpreted by **GE**, or four (with c^1), as it is recorded in [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**).

Bar 86 L.H. **FE** (→**EE**) overlooks $a\flat$ in the grace-note chord.

Bar 87 We give the octaves on the fourth quaver according to **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**). The notes $a\flat$ and $a\flat^2$ were added in **FE** (→**EE**). This is probably an error of the engraver, suggested by the continuum of previous chords. In **A** Chopin crossed out the c^2-$a\flat^2$-c^3 chord in the R.H. and replaced it with an empty octave.

Bar 93 L.H. At the beginning of the bar, **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**) has only the lower C. In the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**) Chopin added c.

p. 40 *Bar 99* The rhythmic record of this bar in the sources is not clear. **A** (→[**FC**]→**FE**→**EE**) contains the following script:

Our attention is drawn to the following discrepancies between rhythmic values and the graphic arrangement:
— in **A** the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave ascribed to the third quaver of the bar is located distinctly in the middle of the bar (on the fourth quaver)
— the direction of the stems in the R.H. suggests that the b-d^1 third comprises a second voice, filling the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave. Basic doubt is produced, therefore, by the moment of striking the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave — on the third or fourth quaver of the bar. Two solutions come to mind:
1. With the assumption that the proper localisation of particular touches in the bar is described by the rhythmic values, the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave coincides with the t h i r d quaver of the bar. This solution is dictated by the following arguments:
— Chopin's script does not contain an obvious error and was proof-read by him in **A** (𝄾 on the fifth quaver of the bar was clearly added later); this fact explains the appearance of the described discrepancies
— Chopin did not alter the rhythm either in [**FC**] or in **FE** or in any of the four pupils' copies
— it could have been Chopin's intention to achieve a rhythmic and expressive differentiation of bars 99 and 101 (the syncopation in bar 99 would correspond to syncopations in bars 88-94); a similar arrangement of rhythms is encountered in the *Ballade in G minor* Op. 23, bars 167 and 169
— despite the fact that the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave was not sustained to the end of the bar, the direction of the stems clearly indicates a two-voice treatment of the R.H part. This is the version we present in the main text.
2. With the assumption that a proper localisation of particular touches in the bar is determined by the graphic arrangement of **A**, it is necessary to correct the values of the rests; this will lead to the version, presented in the variant, in which the $a\flat$-$a\flat^1$ octave is struck on the f o u r t h quaver of the bar. This solution is favoured by:
— the way of distribution and the rhythmic values of n o t e s in **A**; this suggestion is so distinct that **GE**, based on it, changed the quaver rests on the second quaver of the bar to crotchet rests
— the rhythmic analogy with bar 101.

Bars 99-100 and 101-102 R.H. The text without ties sustaining melodic sounds comes from **A** (→[**FC**]→**FE**→**EE**, →**GE**1). The *ossia* variants given in the footnote come from **FE**D (bars 99-100) and **FE**Sch (bars 101-102). The variant in bars 99-100 has two forms corresponding to two possibilities of interpreting the rhythm in bar 99. In the first — the rhythmic value of the upper $a\flat^1$ had to be corrected. It must be stressed that in **FE**S and **FE**J the ties have not been added in any of the two passages, and that Chopin did not add ties in two places simultaneously in any of the pupils' copies. The introduction of two ties in **GE**2 was an arbitrary revision, adopted by the majority of the later collected editions.

Bars 100-101 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily join $e\flat^1$ notes.

Bar 101-102 L.H. The tie joining both $e\flat^1$ was overlooked in [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**). This error was adopted by some of the later collected editions, with an arbitrary change from $e\flat^1$ to e^1 at the beginning of bar 102.

Bars 102-103 R.H. The tie joining both g^1 was overlooked in [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**).

Bar 107 L.H. The last quaver in the sources is the chord d-g-b. The analogous bar 56 contains a g-b third, and in bar 60 Chopin crossed out the lower note in a previously written triad in **A**. In this situation, it seems highly probable that in bar 107 Chopin did not correct the triad owing to carelessness (when proof-reading Chopin quite often missed one of the recurring similar passages).

Bars 109-112 and 150-153 L.H. Chopin could not decide how to mark the tenor voice distinctive in those bars. In **A** he originally wrote accents between the notes of the L.H. intervals but then crossed them out, recognising that the accents-diminuendos between staves were sufficient. However, in print, with greater spaces in between the staves than in **A**, this proved to be unclear for the performers and in pupils' copies Chopin added suitable accents (in **FE**D) or slurs (**FE**S and **FE**J).

p. 41 *Bar 121* L.H. At the beginning of the bar **GE** contains a mistaken octave $E\flat_1$-$E\flat$.

Bar 122 L.H. Certain later collected editions arbitrarily change the top notes of the chords to g^1 and $a\flat^1$.

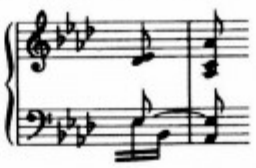
Bar 125 L.H. In the last chord [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**) overlooks the note $d\flat^1$.

Bar 132 L.H. The main text comes from **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**), and the variant — from **FE** (→**EE**). The **FE** version is most probably a simplified correction of a printing error (presumably, the third quaver was originally completely omitted).

p. 42 *Bar 137* This bar was overlooked in **GE**.

Bar 138 R.H. The first chord in **A** has the mistaken value of a quaver.

Bar 140 R.H. **GE**2 arbitrarily ties the $a\flat^2$-$a\flat^3$ octaves.

Bars 143-144 The bars in **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**) are linked as follows:

Chopin simplified this in the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**).

p. 43 *Bar 157* R.H. In **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**) the chord on the third quaver of the bar has no e^1. Chopin added this note in the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**).

Bar 158 R.H. In **A** (→**GE**) the note $g\sharp$ appears on the fourth quaver. It is difficult to say whether its absence in [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**) is an oversight of the copyist or a correction by Chopin.

Bars 160-161 R.H. The tie joining both b was overlooked in [**FC**] (→**FE**→**EE**) and in **GE** it was reproduced imprecisely.

Bar 162 R.H. It is not clear whether Chopin wished to repeat or sustain the chord on the fourth quaver of the bar. **A** (→**GE**1) and **FE** (→**EE**) do not have ties, which, however, appeared in [**FC**] (→**SC**) and have been added by Chopin in **FE**D. Stylistically both versions are possible since this motif appears in the *Ballade* in both forms.

p. 44 *Bar 173* R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily give the triad $c\sharp^2$-e^2-$g\sharp^2$ as the ninth semiquaver.

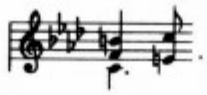
Bar 176 In the main text we give the version introduced by Chopin in the proofs of **FE**2 (→**EE**). The variant is basically a version of **A** (→[**FC**],**GE**); only on the third semiquaver in the R.H. did we remove the note b^1 — similarly to the **FE**2 version (apparently, this simplification of the chord, rather awkward in high tempo, can be treated as independent of the remaining changes in this bar).

Bar 178 R.H. The majority of the later collected editions gives $c\sharp^2$ instead of the authentic $g\sharp^2$ as the fourth semiquaver. It seems worthwhile to draw attention to the association of the span of the R.H. figures with the span of the L.H. chords: at the end of bar 173 the octave $c\sharp^3$-$c\sharp^4$ is accompanied by the chord $c\sharp^1$-e^1-$g\sharp^1$-$c\sharp^2$ and in bar 178 the eleventh $g\sharp^2$-$c\sharp^4$ is accompanied by the chord $g\sharp$-$c\sharp^1$-e^1-$c\sharp^2$.
L.H. FC (→FE→EE) overlooks the note $c\sharp^1$ in the chord on the third quaver of the bar.

Bar 179 L.H. **A** (→[FC],GE) has the $F\sharp$-$f\sharp$ octave on the third quaver. Chopin transferred it an octave higher in the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**).

p. 45 *Bars 195-196* R.H. At the beginning of bar 196 **A** (→[FC],GE) has a rest in the upper voice. In the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**) Chopin changed it to a b-d^1 third (tied to the previous one).

Bar 199 R.H. In **A** the lengthening dots next to the second chord have been overlooked.
R.H. Next to the lower sound of the last chord in **FE**D Chopin altered ♭ to ♮. We give this version as *ossia*.

Bar 200 R.H. In the first half of the bar **A** (→[FC]→**FE**1, →**GE**) has the following version: . We accept the version introduced by Chopin in the proofs of **FE**2 (→**EE**).

p. 46 *Bar 203* R.H. In the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**) Chopin added a sustained note c^1 on the fourth quaver of the bar.

Bar 211 R.H. **A** has the f^1-f^2 octave on the second quaver; we also see that Chopin crossed out the inner sound. This procedure proved to be unclear for readers of **A** since both **GE** and [FC] (→**FE**→**EE**) have the chord f^1-d^2-f^2 at this point.

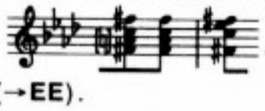
Bar 213 L.H. **A** (→[FC]) has a four-note chord on the third quaver. In it both **GE** and **FE** (→**EE**) overlook the note $e\flat^1$.

Bar 214 L.H. **A** (→[FC],GE) has an $e\flat^1$-$a\flat^1$-c^2 chord on the fourth quaver. In the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**) Chopin removed the note $a\flat^1$.
R.H. In **A** the fifth quaver is written rather indistinctly and it is not clear whether $a\flat^3$ is included in it or not. **GE** has only c^4, and [FC] (→**FE**→**EE**) has the $a\flat^3$-c^4 third.

Bar 215 R.H. The note g^3 in the first chord in **A** (→**GE**) is sustained by a tie but not distinguished as a dotted crotchet. We correct this imprecision of notation. [FC] (→**FE**→**EE**) omits the tie joining both g^3.

Bar 216 The main text comes from **FE** (→**EE**) where it was introduced by Chopin in his proofs of **FE**1 (visible traces of changes in print). The variant is a version of **A** (→**GE**). SC has the same rhythm as **FE** but the manner of notation testifies to the fact that Saint-Saëns added this rhythm to the **A** version i.e. that [FC] had the **A** version.

Bars 219 and 221 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add ties sustaining the crotchet g^2 (as in bar 215). The repetition of g^2 in those bars is connected with a harmonic context in the L.H., different from bar 215.

p. 47 *Bars 228-229* R.H. The bars in **A** (→[FC],GE) are linked as follows: . Chopin altered this in the proofs of **FE**1 (→**EE**).

4. Ballade in F minor, Op. 52

Sources

AI A 79-bar fragment of an autograph of the first edition of the *Ballade*, in the original 6/4 metre (private collection, photocopy in the Chopin Society, Warsaw).

[**A**1], [**A**2] — the lost first and second of the three autographs which served as bases for first editions.

A3 Fragment, containing 136 bars, of the chronologically last autograph/fair-copy (Bodleian Library, Oxford), intended as the basis for the first German edition. **A**3 was partially copied from [**A**1], and partially from [**A**2]; it also contains improvements and errors which are absent in all earlier autographs.

[**A**3] Lost end fragment of **A**3.

FE1 First French edition, M. Schlesinger (M.S. 3957), Paris XII 1843. **FE**1 was based on [**A**1] and was most probably corrected by Chopin.

FE2 Second impression of **FE**1 (the same firm and number). Several small changes introduced in **FE**2 could be the outcome of its superficial review by Chopin.

FE = **FE**1 and **FE**2.

FEJ As in the *Ballade in F*, Op. 38.

EE First English edition, Wessel & C° (W & C° 5305), London III 1844. **EE** was based on [**A**2] and was not corrected by Chopin; it contains numerous errors.

GE First German edition, Breitkopf & Härtel (7001), Leipzig XI 1843. **GE** reproduces with errors the text of **A**3 and [**A**3]; it was not corrected by Chopin.

Editorial Principles

We have based our text on **A**3 and, from bar 137, on **GE**, compared with **FE** and **EE**.

p. 48 *Bars 1-2 and 4* **GE** arbitrarily simplifies Chopin's notation, omitting *legato* in bar 1, stems and beams distinguishing the R.H. lower voice in bars 2 and 4, and transferring the L.H. motif in bars 1-2 to the lower staff. This distorted notation was repeated in the majority of the later collected editions.

Bar 1-5 R.H. Dynamic markings in parentheses come from **FE**.

Bar 7 R.H. In the first half of the bar **A** (→**GE**) mistakenly repeats the second half of bar 6. **FE**1 also contains an error: f^1-c^2 on the fourth semiquaver. The correct text is found in **EE** and **FE**2.

Bars 16 and 30 L.H. The sonority of the second quaver in bar 16 and the fifth quaver in bar 30 gives rise to doubt. In bar 16 all sources have the $e\flat^1$-f^1-a^1 chord but in bar 30 it occurs only in **A**I and **EE**, while **FE** and **A**3 (→**GE**) have the $e\flat^1$-a^1 interval. In **A**3 it is clear that in bar 30 Chopin crossed out the f^1 in the originally written chord. Since those bars constitute part of double-bar phrases, otherwise completely identical, it seems that it was not the intention of Chopin to differentiate this detail of the accompaniment. Two hypotheses come to mind:
— by crossing out f^1 while looking through **A** Chopin mistook bar 30 for one of similar bars (21 or 36); therefore, the version concurrent with his intention would be the one which ignores this crossing-out and which is as a whole and without errors recorded in [**A**2] (→**EE**, our main text). In this version, the presence of the three- or two-note chord is connected with the preceding harmonic context: in bars 16 and 30 the first, from several bars appearance of the bass *F* is accompanied by a three-note chord while bars 21 and 36 (as well as 56 and 150), which end the several-bars fragments based on F as the pedal point, have a two-note one
— Chopin resigned completely from three-note chords in these passages, and bar 16 remained uncorrected due to carelessness (when proof-reading Chopin quite often missed one of the recurring similar passages); we take this possibility into consideration as a variant.

p. 50 *Bars 43-44* R.H. The main text comes from **FE** and **EE**, the variant — from **A**3 (→**GE**). Although the absence of ties in **A**3 could be an oversight on the part of Chopin, both versions are musically justified:
— in a sustention of the chord, the four-bar phrases which start in the middle of bars 38 and 42 are rhythmically analogous
— in a repetition of the chord, there come into being two pairs of rhythmically corresponding bars — bars 38 and 40 and bars 42 and 44.

Bar 46 L.H. On the second quaver **GE** mistakenly has an additional c^1.

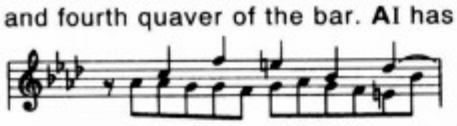
Bar 48 L.H. The main text comes from **A**I, **EE** and **A**3 (→**GE**), and the variant — from **FE**. In the main version the consistent use of chords ensures bars 47-49 a uniform sonority. In the variant, the repetition in bar 48 of intervals from bar 46 makes it possible for the harmony of the first half of bar 50, which constitutes a turning point of the harmonic progression in bars 46-53, to appear more distinctly.

Bar 51 L.H. On the second quaver **A**I, **FE** and **EE** have the chord $a\flat$-$e\flat^1$-$g\flat^1$. We accept the version of **A**3 (→**GE**) in which the chords on the second and third quavers have two notes in common, as in neighbouring figures.

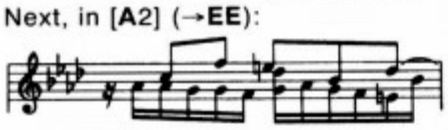
Bar 55 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily change the lower note of the initial chord from $e\flat^1$ to $g\flat^1$.

Bar 56 L.H. In the last chord **FE** mistakenly omits $e\flat^1$. *Cf.* bars 16, 21 and analogous ones.

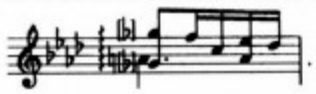
p. 51 *Bar 58* R.H. Sources differ as regards the sonority of the third and fourth quaver of the bar. **A**I has a strictly two-part version:



In [**A**1] (→**FE**) Chopin supplemented it:

Next, in [**A**2] (→**EE**):

and in **A**3 (→**GE**, the version accepted in our edition) Chopin successively resigned from three-note chords by returning to a strict two-part texture, but with a line of the lower voice modified in comparison to previous versions.

Bar 59 R.H. **FE** has c^1-$b\flat^1$ as the first semiquaver of the lower voice.

Bar 65 R.H. We give the second half of the bar according to **A**I and **EE**. Also **A**3 (→**GE**) has a similar version, which differs only because the a^1 note in the chord is not lengthened to a dotted crotchet. **FE** contains the following version:

. The lower note of the chord ($g\flat^1$) could be an error made by the engraver. The authenticity of note a^1 repeated on the last but one semiquaver does not give rise to doubts but its absence in **EE** and **A**3 probably signifies that Chopin ultimately resigned from it.

Bar 68 R.H. **GE** mistakenly ties notes a^1 in the two first quavers.

Bar 72 R.H. In the chord on the second semiquaver of the second half of the bar **FE** and **EE** have $e\flat^1$ instead of $d\flat^1$ which is found in **A**I and **A**3 (→**GE**). The **FE** and **EE** version could be an engravers' error, possibly committed under the impact of the previous chord (Chopin wrote notes of seconds one over the other, and not diagonally next to each other). This is the reason why we accept $d\flat^1$ which appears in both extant manuscripts, and which makes the $c\flat^1$-$d\flat^1$ second sound in all the chords of the second half of the bar, analogously to the $b\flat\flat$-$c\flat^1$ second from the first half.

Bars 72-73 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily change the last but one semiquaver in bar 72 from $b\flat^1$ to $b\flat\flat^1$. Others moreover alter the middle notes of chords: in bar 72 on the eighth and tenth semiquaver from $d\flat^1$ to $e\flat\flat^1$, and in bar 73 on the fourth semiquaver from $e\flat^1$ to $f\flat^1$ and on the tenth semiquaver from f^1 to $g\flat^1$.

p. 52 *Bar 74* L.H. The quaver beginning the second half of the bar, similarly as the three previous semiquavers, is recorded in the sources on the upper staff, under the R.H. part. Therefore, by taking into consideration the *all'ottava* sign, it should be read as f^2. The shape of figures in the L.H. in the previous two bars, however, testifies to the fact that Chopin was thinking of f^1 and made a mistake by transferring the L.H. part to the lower staff only in the three last semiquavers of the bar.

Bar 81 R.H. In **FE** and **EE** the melodic note d^1 in the second half of the bar is not lengthened by a dot or distinguished from the $b\flat$-d^1 third.

Bar 83 L.H. The first crotchet in **FE** is a *G*-*d* fifth. We accept the **EE** and **A**3 (→**GE**) version which stems more naturally from the previous chord. The absence of *d* in this version makes it possible to avoid counter-parallel fifths in relation with the successive chord. Some of the later collected editions accept the **FE** version and arbitrarily add the note *d* on the last quaver of bar 82.

Bar 85-86 R.H. **FE** has no tie sustaining f^1.

Bars 87-88 R.H. In **A**3 (→**GE**) there are no ties sustaining the $a\flat^1$-$b\flat^1$-f^2 chord. The repetition of this chord at the end of the phrasing slur seems to be of little probability and rather indicates that Chopin overlooked the ties.

p. 53 *Bar 92* R.H. In the middle of the bar **FE** does not lengthen note d^2 with a dot and on the last quaver it has a sixth d^1-$b\flat^1$. We accept the **EE** and **A**3 (→**GE**) version (in **A**3 Chopin crossed out $b\flat^1$ and added a dot lengthening the sonority of d^2).

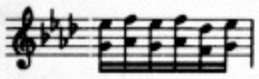
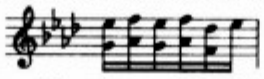
Bars 94-95 Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add ties joining chords over the bar-line.

Bar 99 L.H. At the beginning of the second half of the bar **FE** and **EE** have the chord $B\flat$-*f*-$b\flat$. We accept the **A**3 (→**GE**) version.

Bars 99-100 R.H. **GE** overlooks the tie sustaining d^1.

Bar 104 L.H. In the main text we give the **A**3 (→**GE**) version in which the melody in the octaves stems in the most natural way from the five-semiquaver transition in bar 103. The version given in the footnote comes from **FE** and **EE**.

Bars 108-109 and 110-111 R.H. In **A**3 (→**GE**) the sixth d^2-$b\flat^2$ in bars 108-109 is sustained by ties. In analogous bars 110--111 **A**3 discloses crossed out ties sustaining c^2-$a\flat^2$. **FE** and **EE** do not have ties in any of those passages. In the majority of the later collected editions the sixths are tied arbitrarily in both pairs of bars. The **A**3 version, with a differentiation of those passages, characteristic for Chopin, is most probably the final one.

p. 54 *Bar 113* R.H. The first half of the bar in **EE** sounds as follows: and in **A**3 (→**GE**): 
These versions can testify to the fact that Chopin wavered in choosing the best place for interrupting the continuous progression of the sixths; they could be also the consequence of the mistakes made by Chopin and the engraver of **EE**. We accept the **FE** version since it is:
— musically the smoothest and pianistically the most convenient
— confirmed by a concurrent version of the analogous bar 115.

Bar 118 L.H. The main text comes from **FE** and **A**3 (→**GE**), the variant — from **EE**. An interval on top of the progression of chords is one of the devices used by Chopin (e.g. the *Ballade in G minor* Op. 23, bar 207), while the three-note chord alleviates somewhat the effect of the simultaneously struck doubled third g^2-g^3.

Bar 123 R.H. **A**3 (→**GE**) overlooks the tie sustaining $a♭^1$.

Bar 124 R.H. The oversights of accidentals occurring in some sources in the second half of the bar — the absence of ♮ next to c^2 in **FE** and **A**3 (→**GE**) and the absence of ♮ next to f^2 in **A**3 (→**GE**) — inclined the editors of the majority of the later collected editions to change those notes to $c♭^2$ and $f♭^2$. It should be stressed that f^2 on the last but one semiquaver does not give rise to doubts, neither as regards the sources (the flat is absent in all cases, and two sources contain naturals) nor musical (*cf.* a similar device which anticipates the major key in the *Sonata in B♭ minor* Op. 35, first movement, bar 168 and a similar juxtaposition of f♭ and f in adjoining octaves in this *Ballade*, bar 62, and in the *Waltz in A♭* Op. 34 No. 1, bars 251-252), while c^2 in the ninth semiquaver is justified by tonal relations (despite the false modulations to D♭ minor in bars 121-124, A♭ major remains the basic key from bar 115 on) and gives a smoother progression of the top semiquavers in each pair ($f♭^1$-c^2-f^2).

p. 55 *Bars 125-126* L.H. **A**3 (→**GE**) overlooks the tie sustaining $b♭$.

Bar 127 L.H. The main text comes from **EE**, the variant — from **FE** and **A**3 (→**GE**). We give priority to the **EE** version, unquestioned in this place, since we cannot exclude the possibility that the [**A**1] (→**FE**) version, copied in **A**3, is only an earlier notation, deformed by the overlooking of a tie sustaining $A♭$ on the third eighth.

Bars 127-128 L.H. **GE** overlooks the tie linking $A♭$ with $G♯$.

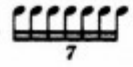
Bar 130 R.H. On the fourth semiquaver **FE** has no $g♯^1$.

Bar 134 R.H. Note a^1 on the sixth semiquaver in **FE** has the value of a semiquaver; in **EE** this sound is written as a quaver tied with an additional dotted crotchet.

Bar 136 N. B. A3 ends with this bar.

p. 56 *Bar 144* L.H. On the fifth and sixth quaver **FE**1 has no $g♭^1$ or $f♭^1$. In **FE**2 $f♭^1$ is supplemented, possibly upon the basis of [**A**1]. We give the **EE** and **GE** version.

Bar 150 R.H. The main text comes from **FE** and **EE**, the variant — from **GE**. The absence of [**A**3] makes it impossible to say whether the sustaining of $e♭^2$ is an authentic variant or an error of **GE**.

Bar 153 R.H. In the first half of the bar **FE** has the following rhythm: 

Bar 154 L.H. The last semiquaver in **GE** is most probably the mistaken c^2. This sort of an error was committed at times by Chopin and particularly often by the engravers of **GE** (e.g. in bar 159, where the last semiquaver is c^2 instead of a^1).

p. 57 *Bars 156-157* R.H. **GE** has no tie sustaining $a♭^2$.

Bars 164 and 165 R.H. Prior to the fifth semiquaver **EE** in both bars and **GE** in bar 165 add ♮. This sort of supplementation is one of the most frequent arbitrary revisions of those editions (*cf.* commentary to the *Ballade in G minor* Op. 23, bars 45 and 47). In both cases **FE** has flats.

p. 58 *Bar 167* R.H. The main text comes from **FE** and **GE**, the variant — from **EE**.

Bar 174 R.H. At the beginning of the second half of the bar **FE** has the chord $d♭^1$-$c♭^2$-$d♭^2$. We give the final version of **EE** and **GE**.

Bar 176 L.H. The main text comes from **FE** and **GE**, and the variant — from **EE**.

p. 59 *Bar 184* L.H. The main text comes from **GE**, and the variant — from **FE** and **EE**.

Bar 185 L.H. As the fourth and sixth semiquaver **FE** has the most probably mistaken $d♭^1$ and $B♭$.

p. 60 *Bar 190* L.H. The main text comes from **EE** and **GE**, and the variant — from **FE**. From the point of view of sonority the wider figuration of the **FE** version corresponds to the development of the theme as a whole (from bar 169). In **EE** and **GE** Chopin resigned from it in favour of a passage remaining within the framework designated by the directly preceding figures. *Cf.* a similarly justified variant at the end of the *Ballade in F* Op. 38.

p. 61 *Bars 198-202* The crescendo sign and ***fff*** come from **FE**, where Chopin probably added them in the proofs.

Bar 200 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily add $c♯^2$ to the first chord.

p. 62 *Bar 217* L.H. The main text comes from **EE** and **GE**. In the variant we give a pianistically slightly more difficult version of **FE**, which offers fuller harmony.

Bar 221 L.H. The **GE** version given in the footnote may be mistaken: Chopin frequently placed notes under the first line much lower, which in this case could have inclined the engraver to read *F* as *D♭*.

Bars 223 and 225 R.H. Some of the later collected editions arbitrarily change f^1 to $e♭^1$ on the first semiquaver.

Bar 226 R.H. In the last chord there is no c^2 in **FE**.

p. 63 *Bar 227* L.H. Instead of a semiquaver triplet, **EE** has a F_1-F quaver. This version, analogous to the beginning of bar 225, was probably replaced by Chopin with the **FE** and **GE** version, which does not interrupt the sequence of semiquavers and gives a logical beginning to the figures in the R.H.
L.H. In **FE** and **GE** the second semiquaver in the second half of the bar is *G*. This is probably an original or mistaken version of [**A**1] (→**FE**), copied owing to carelessness in [**A**3] (→**GE**). We give the **EE** version, which does not give rise to doubts and is analogous to bars 228-230.

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Paweł Kamiński

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